

FINAL REPORT

Eleventh General Service Conference

of

Alcoholics Anonymous

Roosevelt Hotel, New York City

April 19 - 23, 1961



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APPROVED BY THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE OF A. A.

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Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
P. O. Box 459, Grand Central Station
New York 17, N. Y.

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1961 FINAL REPORT

General Service Conference of A. A.

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1961 Conference At A Glance

As the link between the groups and the General Service Board of A.A., the Delegates were called upon for decisions and "advisory actions" to guide the Board in its 1961 activities. Highlights of such "advisory actions" are summarized in the following paragraphs.

The Delegates:

1965 CONVENTION

Indicated their approval of a 1965 International Convention of A.A. to be held in the city of Toronto, Ontario, Canada with the clear understanding that all final decisions on a movement-wide gathering of this type are reserved to the Trustees of the General Service Board as custodians of the Fellowship's Traditions and services.

THIRD ONTARIO DELEGATE

Approved, in view of the large geographical area and increasing population involved, a request for a third Delegate from Ontario, Canada, to serve the North and Northwest section of the Province. The new Delegate will be eligible to attend the 1962 Conference. In approving this admission, the Delegates cited the opinion of Bill W., surviving co-founder, that each application for a new Delegate should be weighed on its merits.

OUTSIDE AGENCIES

Reaffirmed the importance of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation, Yes—Affiliation, No" in working with other agencies in the field of alcoholism but encouraged Delegates to establish and maintain communications with the directors of tax-supported state agencies on alcoholism within their respective Areas.

Recognized the growing importance of this field of activity by establishing the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies as a standing committee of the Conference.

LITERATURE

Directed the attention of Spanish-speaking members to the recent availability of seven additional pamphlets in Spanish and recorded with pleasure the offer from Puerto Rico to provide Spanish translators for A.A. material in the future.

Recommended that the study of long-range translation needs of the movement, authorized by the 1960 Conference, be continued in view of the growing opportunities to be of service to alcoholics in non-English-speaking countries.

DIRECTORY INFORMATION

Approved simplified procedure of a single mailing to the groups to obtain information for the World Directory and for G.S.O. records.

A. A. TODAY

(Based on reports to G.S.O.)
Spring, 1961

Groups in U. S.	5,875
Members in U. S.	108,004
Groups in Canada	833
Members in Canada	11,524
Groups Overseas	1,112
Members Overseas	17,737
Internationalists	236
Hospital Groups	360
Members in Hospitals	6,675
Prison Groups	435
Members in Prison	17,373

Totals Reported

8,615 Groups

162,037 Members

(Including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at 300,000)

LONG BEACH FILM

Viewed with appreciation a short film based on footage ordered as an historical record of the 25th Anniversary Convention at Long Beach in 1960. Agreed, however, by an overwhelming majority, that it would not be compatible with the anonymity tradition to release the film for local or Area showings in view of the difficulty of limiting such showings strictly to A.A. members.

MISUSE OF DIRECTORY

Directed the attention of A.A. members once more to the statement on the inside front cover of the Directory which specifies that the book is not to be used for any form of solicitation or for any commercial venture. (The Delegates noted that this restriction is not intended to limit "free communication" among members in sharing A.A. experience.)

PROPOSED PAPERBACK BOOK

Rejected, after hearing a detailed presentation of the financial factors involved, a proposal to issue the "Big Book" in a paperback edition.

DELEGATES' CHAIRMAN

Vince S. of Southern Minnesota was chosen by lot to be chairman of the 1962 "Area Delegates Only" meeting.

G. S. O. SERVICES

Reports presenting major 1960 G.S.O. services during the past year are summarized on the following pages. All were approved unanimously by the Delegates to the 1961 General Service Conference.

SUPPORT OF SERVICES

Recommended adoption, or continued use, of the so-called Birthday Plan to provide "supplementary" support of A.A.'s world services. (Under the plan, individual members, on their "A.A." birthdays, contribute a dollar per year for each year of sobriety up to a fixed amount.) The desirability of the "\$3. per year per member "yardstick" was reaffirmed since many groups are not able to support world service on this basis.

Suggested that interested groups undertake careful studies of various plans available to them to increase their support of world services, with a view to adopting and supporting that plan which seems most suitable for a particular group.

Approved a proposal that the General Service Board set aside a specific allocation of funds for a one-year period through which overseas groups might be assisted in their efforts to publish Conference-approved translations of pamphlets now available from G.S.O. and other pamphlets.

ANONYMITY

Approved present plans of the General Service Board to issue its third general mailing to media on the significance of anonymity in the recovery program and structure of the Fellowship. The mailing, first of its kind in three years, will go to a broad list of publishers, broadcasters and film producers in the U.S., Canada and other selected countries.

NEW TRUSTEES

Approved the G.S.B. nomination of Tom S. of Jacksonville, Florida, and Dave B. of Montreal, Canada, to fill the positions of A.A. Trustees of the Board which became vacant this Spring.

Approved the G.S.B. nomination of Austin MacCormick, noted penologist and former Trustee, as a non-alcoholic Trustee.

BILL W.

Asked the General Service Board of Trustees to consider specific action, in respect of royalty payments on textbook literature, to assure that co-Founder Bill and his wife, Lois, may not suffer a possible loss of income in the future.

GRAPEVINE

Endorsed a "Grapevine group sponsorship program" under which groups are encouraged to send a new subscription each month to outside agencies or interested non-alcoholic friends of A.A.

Established as a goal for 1961 an increase of 5,000 in the number of Grapevine subscriptions.

Reaffirmed the value of the program to establish "Grapevine Representation" at State, Area and Group levels.

THE SENSE OF THE MEETING

Determination To Work and Grow Together, And With Others, Marked Eleventh General Service Conference

What was the true "sense of the meeting" that might be recorded for the benefit of future generations of A.A.s who may be interested in the deliberations of the Eleventh Annual General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous?

Dedicated To Service

All Conferences share many characteristics in common. Each of the ten preceding gatherings had been dedicated to service, for example. In each, there had been growing awareness of A.A.'s potential for helping alcoholics around the world. In each, also, there had been underlying currents of spirituality and responsibility that illuminated many otherwise mundane deliberations. And, particularly in recent years, there had been increasing appreciation of the importance of improving the channels and techniques through which members of the Fellowship communicate with each other and with the world about us.

Absence of Fear

The Eleventh Conference shared all these characteristics with its predecessors. But, to a few observers at least, the 1961 Conference was distinctive in its own right.

There was an absence of fear for the future of A.A. in this Conference. These were Delegates who knew from experience that this Fellowship can survive any foreseeable crisis if it will but adhere to its best principles. This was a confident Conference, but not a complacent one.

This was a Conference of men and women with broad A.A. horizons, not limited or influenced exclusively by local or Area needs, but by the needs of A.A. as a whole—the needs of the alcoholic in the Africa bush, on tropic isles and in Arctic wastes. Surely this breadth of vision was a distinctive mark of the 1961 gathering.

This was a Conference that expressed, perhaps more clearly than any that had gone before, the inescapable reality that we must live and communicate with the outside world even if we have no desire to change it.

And it was, finally, a Conference that was undeniably aware of our overriding necessity to work and grow together as a Fellowship, overlooking the petty differences that do not threaten us and concentrating on the great unifying concepts of service—of Twelfth Step work—with which we can move forward together in sobriety.

Steps of Growth

The difference between the Eleventh Conference and, for example, the first meeting of Delegates in 1951, was certainly not one of quality. No Conference can ever be "better" than any other so long as all remain dedicated to A.A.'s primary purpose.

The difference between the 1951 Conference and the Eleventh Conference was the sum of the small steps of growth along the path that began in Akron, Ohio in 1935. This was a Conference that could look *back* upon the Long Beach Convention and hear echoes testifying to A.A.'s acceptance in many lands. This was a Conference that could *look outward* and *reach outward* to help groups overseas with translations of A.A. literature. This was a Conference that could *look forward*, pledging itself and its servants to new responsibilities and new daily chores.

The Upward Look

And this was a Conference, let it not be forgotten, that was discerning enough to know that all men must ultimately look in another direction—*upward*—from which the great gift that is A.A. derives all its meaning.

New Chairman Hails 1961 Conference As 'One of Finest'

Dr. John L. Norris, incoming non-alcoholic Chairman of the General Service Board, paid a special tribute to Mr. Leonard Harrison, his predecessor as Chairman, in brief remarks during the closing dinner Saturday night.

Dr. Norris, who is Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company, termed Mr. Harrison, also one of A.A.'s great friends among non-alcoholics, "one of the builders of A.A., one of the men for whom, had the word 'gentlemen' not already existed, it would have had to be created."

"It is one of the feelings of great assurance I have as I face my period of time as Chairman of your Board to know that Leonard Harrison is still going to be with us on the Board, still backing us up, still there with his wise counsel, his smile, his support," Dr. Norris told the Delegates.

The incoming chairman said that he felt the 1961 Conference had been one of the finest in history. Dr. Norris was elected to the Board in 1951, the first year of the Conference structure, and has participated actively in Conference affairs since that time.

It is important for all who are interested in the survival and growth of A.A. to "start thinking and talking about world service," rather than about a particular office, Dr. Norris suggested. He noted, however, that "none of us would be here if there were not some place where people could turn for reliable information."

Confidence "that is the sort of basis for a working relationship," depends on good communications, the doctor said. "Communications are not good until they are two-way communications, until—when some one has said something we don't quite understand—we ask: 'Just what did you mean by that,'"

Stressing that the Trustees "have no secrets," Dr. Norris announced that Delegates who wished to see the preliminary draft of Bill's new manuscript on "Twelve Concepts" could obtain a copy for the asking. Earlier, there had been apparent misunderstanding over the availability of this material which has not yet been reviewed formally by the Trustees.

'A TRUE AND A HIGH AND A CONSTANT PURPOSE'

Bill Calls On A. A. To 'Look Out Upon Its Destiny' As A Society

The 1961 Conference, like its predecessors was illuminated by several formal and informal presentations by Bill W., surviving co-founder of A. A. A recurring theme in these talks during the four-day meeting was the importance of the Conference structure to assure sound growth of the Fellowship. Bill also emphasized the need to be realistic in evaluating A. A. activities to date, warning that humility and a spirit of cooperation should mark the Society's relations with others who share A. A.'s concern with the problem of alcoholism.

Key excerpts from Bill's talks follow:

Contrast Between Good, Evil Societies

Since the beginning of recorded time, many societies and nations and civilizations have passed in review. In those great ones that have left their mark for good, in contrast with those who have left their mark for evil, there has been always a sense of history, a true and a high and a constant purpose, and there has always been a sense of destiny.

In the societies which failed to leave a bright mark in the annals of the world, there was always a false or boastful sense of history, always a mistaken or inadequate purpose and always the presumption of an infinite, a glorious and an exclusive destiny.

In the societies that left their mark of goodness on time, the sense of history was not a matter for pride or for glory; it was the substance of the learning of the experience of the past. In the purpose of such a society there was always truth and constancy, but never a supposition that the society had apprehended all of the truth—or the superior truth. And in the sense of destiny there was no conceit, no supposition that a society or nation or culture would last forever and go on to greater glories. But there was always a sense of duty to be fulfilled, whatever destiny the society might be assigned by Providence for the betterment of the world.

This is the crossroad at which we in A. A. stand. This is a good time to re-examine how well we have looked upon our history and how much we have profited by it, what false insights or false glories we may have been extracting from history—to our future detriment. It is a moment to examine the purpose of this Society. Indeed, we are very lucky to be able to state as the nucleus of that purpose a single word: sobriety.

Need For More Quietude

Quite early we saw, however, that sobriety in abstinence from alcohol could never be attained unless there was sobriety and more quietude in the false motivations that underlay our drinking.

When the Twelve Steps were cast up—without any real experience and therefore under some Guidance, surely—we were given keys to sobriety in its wider implications. We have been blessed with a concrete definition of purpose but, for all its concreteness, we could still abuse it and misuse it in a very natural way.

Some times we begin to think that perhaps, according to the

Scriptural promise, the first shall be last and the last—meaning us—shall really be first. That would indeed be a very dangerous presumption and never should we indulge it. If we do, we shall compete in history with other societies who have been ill-advised enough to suppose that they had a monopoly on truth or were in some way superior to other attempts of men to think and to associate in love and in harmony.

We may look out upon our destiny with no violation of our principle that we are to live one day at a time. We mean that, emotionally, each in his personal life is never to repine upon the past, glory too much in the present or presume upon the future. We shall attend to the day's business but we shall try to apprehend ever more truth from the lessons of our history, not the lessons of our successes but the lessons of our defections, failures and the awful emotions that can be set loose upon us. For these, indeed, are the raw materials that God has used to forge this still rather little instrument called Alcoholics Anonymous. So we may look at destiny and we may ask ourselves about it and speculate upon it a little—if we do not presume to play God.

Fresh Freedom Under God

By this singular Providence which has been ours, it has been our privilege to walk through a new door that opened a quarter of a century ago. This quarter century, this brief span of life of Alcoholics Anonymous, has been characterized by exactly the reverse of what has been going on in the world around us. Each turning point in our history has opened up to fresh freedom under God for greater numbers of people.

When I was asked to write a greeting to this Conference, I think I used the word "family" in describing A. A. for perhaps the first time. It occurred to me that we were more than a therapy, more than a group of alcoholics trying to get along in the world. We here in this room were small fragments of a huge and growing family, a fragment collectively designated for the time being as "trusted servants" for the rest and appointed to a mission which would further our purpose and destiny.

Need To Establish Conference

You will remember that at St. Louis a huge transference took place. We old-timers, realizing that we couldn't last forever, also realized that a linkage had to be made between you and this vital beacon of service right here. We realized that this Conference had to be established firmly and that you had to be given the opportunity to look after your own affairs worldwide. We had to apply Tradition Two to ourselves, formally passing the ultimate authority and responsibility over to you and to the generations that will follow you. This powerful experiment had to be tried. One of the most glorious moments in my whole A. A. career was the day when I first realized that in spite of my weaknesses and your weaknesses, we were going to do this—and that it would succeed. But there is more that has to be transferred than just authority and responsibility. And this transfer has been going on a long time. I speak to you of the transfer of service leadership.

1965 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

With only two or three dissenting votes, the 1961 Conference went on record as favoring the holding of a 30th Anniversary International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous in 1965.

Delegates from ten Areas which had expressed interest in being hosts to such a meeting were given opportunities to present three-minute presentations in support of their invitations. These Areas were:

Chicago, Illinois
Colorado (Denver)
Iowa (Des Moines)
Northeastern Texas (Dallas)
Ontario, Canada (Toronto)
Southeastern New York (New York City)
Southeastern Texas (Houston)

Southern Florida (Miami)
Southern New Jersey (Atlantic City)
Western New York (Buffalo)

Voting was conducted by closed ballot to obtain an expression of Conference preference. Of the 93 ballots cast, 53, or more than a majority, favored Toronto as the 1965 Convention site. Twelve votes were cast for Chicago and nine for Dallas.

Trustee John Park Lee, who chaired the meeting, reminded the Delegates that, in accordance with the procedures followed in arranging recent international meetings, the General Service Board reserved the right to make the final determination on financing, programming, site selection and other matters related to a movement-wide meeting.

Bill W. spoke movingly of his willingness to participate informally in a 1965 Convention but urged Delegates not to build plans for such a gathering around himself or Lois.

STUDY COMMITTEE ON RELATIONS WITH OUTSIDE AGENCIES

One of the more significant developments at the 1961 Conference was the unanimous decision to create a Standing Committee on Relations With Outside Agencies. The 1959 Conference had originally established a "special study committee" for work in this area and the 1960 Conference had renewed the life of the committee for another year.

During the past two years the work of the temporary unit had disclosed a wide-spread need for improved communications, both within and outside the movement, to clarify and interpret the Traditional A. A. policy of "Cooperation, Yes; Affiliation, No." Trustee Allan B., chairman of the committee, reported that progress had been made during the year in establishing informal, mutually informative contacts with such groups as the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs, (State and Pro-

vincial public officials concerned with the problem of alcoholism), the National Council on Alcoholism and other agencies.

After hearing Allan's report, the Delegates voted unanimously:

1. To approve expansion of a 1960 "guide" on relations with outside agencies by adding three questions and answers to the document.
2. To approve designation of the G. S. B. Public Information Committee to make contacts with outside agencies on an interim basis.
3. To encourage Delegates to establish improved communications with State and Provincial public officials in the field.
4. To create the Permanent Committee.

1960 CONVENTION FILM (Anonymity Principle Reaffirmed)

In planning for the 25th Anniversary Convention at Long Beach last summer, the General Service Board had authorized the filming of representative scenes at the Convention so that Board archives might contain a pictorial record of the anniversary gathering.

A special film edited from the Long Beach footage was prepared under the supervision of Trustee Al S. for showing at the opening dinner of the 1961 Conference. The film evoked such a favorable response from the Delegates that the question im-

mediately arose whether the film might be released for showings before local or Area A. A. meetings.

The subject was placed on the agenda for review by the Delegates. Although a number of Delegates commented that the film would be of intense interest to groups in their areas, it soon became apparent that a majority were disturbed by the problems involved in "controlling" showings to prevent violations of A. A.'s anonymity Tradition.

On a formal motion to release the film, only eight Delegates voted in favor and the motion was lost.

PROTECTION FOR BILL IN FUTURE

In a moving display of its affection for Bill as the surviving co-founder of A. A. and for Lois, his wife, the Eleventh Conference suggested to the Board of Trustees that changes be made in Bill's current royalty arrangement involving A. A. textbooks to minimize the possibility that Bill's income might be reduced in the future if cheaper editions of A. A. texts are ever produced.

The action was occasioned by a general discussion of the advisability of producing a "cheap edition" of the "Big Book". (See separate Policy page of this report)

In the course of the discussion, Bill reviewed his financial arrangements with the movement, pointing out that all his income derived from book royalties and that he did not receive compensation for his non-writing services to the Fellowship. He stressed that he was not interested in accumulating a large estate but that he was concerned for the welfare of Lois and certain immediate relatives and devoted friends who might require assistance in the event of his passing. He said that he had already deposited with the Trustees an informal "letter of intent" suggesting what disposition might be made of royalties due his estate after his death.

While noting that the reduced royalties from paperback texts would undoubtedly curtail his income, Bill repeated a pledge

that he has given previous Conferences. He said that if royalties under his present contract should become "unseemingly large", he would reduce them voluntarily, or permit the movement to take the initiative in reducing them.

Trustee Dick S. presented the following memorandum which was converted into a motion from the floor and adopted unanimously:

"The Conference recognizes that the publication of cheap editions of A. A. books would probably reduce the income to World Services, and Bill's personal income. This conference unanimously suggests the following to the Trustees: To add a rider to Bill's royalty contract to the effect that, if cheaper books are ever published, Bill's royalties be increased by an amount sufficient to keep the royalty income at the same average level it had been for the five years before cheaper books were published; (further, that) as time goes on, if inflation erodes the purchasing power of this income, the Trustees will adjust the royalties to produce the same approximate purchasing power; this to be effective during the lifetime of Bill and Lois and Bill's legatees."

FINANCIAL SUPPORT OF WORLD SERVICES

The picture of A. A. worldwide that was presented to the Delegates was of an international Fellowship that is continuing to grow, continuing to expand its own services to alcoholics and non-alcoholic friends and continuing to strengthen its relationships with many who share a concern for the problem of alcoholism. At the same time, the Delegates noted that the contributions anticipated from the groups during 1961 will fall short of covering the cost of G. S. O. services.

The concern of the Conference for assuring adequate support of G. S. O. services was expressed in a number of ways. During the panel presentation on "Money and A. A." (See separate page), Delegates from many Conference Areas reported on activities designed to encourage local support of the Office. The sense of the discussion was perhaps summed up in the words of the Delegate who reminded the Conference that the "gimmicks" used to raise funds locally were less important than making sure that individual A. A.s understand the need for service to still-suffering alcoholics.

In more specific terms, the Delegates reminded the movement of the need to retain the "\$3. per year per member" yardstick for group contributions and, while endorsing the so-called "Birth-day Plan" for individual contributions, noted that such plans should be considered "supplementary" to basic group support.

Other recommendations of the Conference Committee on Finances, adopted unanimously by the Delegates, included:

1. Studies by the individual Delegates of various plans available to increase Area support of World Services, with the objective of adopting and supporting the plan most appropriate to each Area. (G. S. O. has background information on a number of plans.) Delegates were urged to report the adoption of any plan by their Areas to the Conference Finance Committee, for discussion in 1962.
2. Approval of an allocation of \$5,000 from the General Fund for a period of one year to assist overseas groups in the preparation of Conference-approved literature.

NO ACTION ON SUGGESTION FOR PAPERBACK EDITION

As has happened at nearly all preceding Conferences, the General Service Office was asked to comment on the feasibility of producing a paperback edition of the Big Book.

Referring to this suggestion, Bill pointed out that many in the movement do not fully appreciate the role of the "Big Book" as the guarantor of the solvency of the General Service Office. He said that no serious objection to production of a "cheap book" would probably be raised if: (1) Group contributions consistently covered the cost of G. S. O. services, (2) Adequate provision had been made for pensions for qualified G. S. O. workers, (3) An adequate reserve fund had been accumulated to safeguard G. S. O.'s survival in periods of economic

stress and (4) The needs of groups overseas were being met.

Bill noted that, in the opinion of experienced publishers, production of a "cheap book" would seriously affect present book sales with no assurance of large sales for the paperback edition.

Herb M., Chairman of A. A. World Services, pointed out that a substantial file of background information had been assembled in connection with various proposals for paperback editions of A. A. texts and that this data was available for review by interested Delegates.

It was recorded as the sense of the meeting that no action be taken by the 1961 Conference on the proposal for a paperback edition of the "Big Book".

THIRD DELEGATE ADMITTED FROM ONTARIO

At the 1960 Conference, the Delegates had reviewed a request for the admission of a third Delegate from the Province of Ontario, Canada, and had referred it to the Policy Committee of the General Service Board for further study in the light of total Conference needs.

Prior to the convening of the 1961 Conference, the views of the Board on the general subject of enlarging the Conference had been reflected in a special memorandum prepared by Bill.

The 1961 Conference Committee on Admissions used this memorandum as a guide in recommending to the Delegates this year that Ontario be allocated a third Delegate to serve the North-West section of the Province. The Committee noted the large geographical area to be covered and the increasing A. A.

population of the Province. The new Delegate will be eligible to attend the 1962 General Service Conference.

In this memorandum, Bill had pointed out:

"The Conference Committee on Admissions should weigh each new application for a new Delegate on its own merit, taking into consideration the primary factors of population, geography—and also expense. But this process of adding Delegates ought to be gradual, aiming at the remedy of obvious and marked flaws in communications . . .

"It should be re-emphasized that the Conference is not a political body demanding a completely rigid formula of representation. What we shall need will always be enough Delegates at New York to afford a reliable cross-section of A. A. plus enough more to make sure of good local communication."

FACT FILE ON CLUBHOUSES AUTHORIZED

The report of the special Study Committee on A. A.'s Relations With Clubs, based largely on a G. S. O. survey of 320 "registered" club facilities, stirred substantial comment and discussion. (See Clubhouse Survey on another page.)

Discussion from the floor disclosed that there exists within the movement a wide range of opinion on the value of clubs and the role they should play within, or close to, the structure of the Fellowship. There was decisive agreement, however, on the de-

sirability of keeping the Society as a whole informed on trends in this field.

The Conference voted unanimously to authorize the General Service Office to prepare a fact file covering movement-wide experience with several types of clubhouses and their relation to A. A. and the community. The availability of the new fact file is to be announced in the A. A. Exchange Bulletin.

CONFERENCE SIDELIGHTS

At the dinner opening the Conference Wednesday evening, Bill W. paid a special tribute to the memory of Hank Grieme, former chairman of A. A. World Services, who died of a heart attack while visiting A. A. groups in Ireland last Fall. Hank had been vice-chairman and the directing spirit behind the first ten Conferences.

"The General Service Office, not only in its equipment and its organization but in its spiritual content and vitality, is very much a monument to our dear Hank", Bill said.

* * * *

The 1961 Conference consisted of 84 Delegates from the United States, Canada and Puerto Rico, together with three non-voting "observers" representing groups in Norway, The Netherlands and Honduras.

* * * *

By a formal resolution, the Conference expressed its gratitude to the sponsors of "The Catholic Hour," network radio series which has recently included several programs on alcoholism, with specific and detailed references to the A. A. program.

Each present member of the Board of Trustees (both A. A. and non-alcoholic) attended one or more Conference sessions. Several Trustees participated actively in more than one meeting.

* * * *

Jack W., (Southern Coastal California) brought a message from Long Beach Convention and Visitors Bureau, commenting in flattering terms on A. A.'s 25th Anniversary Convention last July.

* * * *

As is customary, G. S. O. prepared special portfolios of Conference material for distribution to the Delegates as they registered. The portfolios contained advance texts of all G. S. O. reports, summaries of the activities of previous Conferences and detailed financial data on world service operations.

* * * *

The Delegates approved unanimously a proposal to extend the arrangement whereby former Area Delegates receive mailings of pertinent data from G. S. O.

PUBLIC RELATIONS - LOCAL, AREA & MOVEMENTWIDE

The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous has a responsibility to serve still-suffering alcoholics by keeping the public informed of the availability of the Twelve Step recovery program, Allan B., chairman of a special panel presentation on "Public Relations" told the Delegates. Allan said the General Service Board of Trustees had recognized and affirmed this responsibility in a policy statement, "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping People Informed," adopted in October, 1960. All Delegates received a copy of this statement.

"Partly as a consequence of 25th Anniversary activities, many new and old friends in communications media have asked the G.S.O. to place them on a mailing list so that they can be kept informed of matters relating to the movement in the future." Subject to Conference approval, the Board has authorized the creation of such a list, since none had previously existed, and the issuance of a factual report on A.A. at the close of the Conference. The Trustees have set forth rigid controls governing public information activities to assure continuing adherence to the movement's traditional public relations policy of "attraction rather than promotion."

Panel members also reported on:

1. The continuing interest of news media in receiving factual

information about A.A., "a story with a heart in it." (Niles P., member of the G.S.B. Public Information Committee and a former newspaperman.)

2. Excellent results obtained locally through cooperation with the "A.A. Week" project sponsored by the Advertising Council in connection with the 25th Anniversary Convention. (Jerry M., Washington.)
3. Nationwide response to the "A.A. Week" project resulting in greatly increased inquiries to G.S.O. and intergroup offices. (George O'H., Director, A.A. World Services.)
4. Preparation of special material to aid A.A. speakers before non-A.A. groups. (Burt G. of G.S.O. and Betty T., Southwest, Ohio). The number of requests for speakers is increasing, Betty reported.

Bill W. commented briefly on the development of A.A. public relations policy, pointing out that if the early members had not made direct efforts to attract the interest of the Saturday Evening Post, the famous Jack Alexander article might never have been written. The important objective, Bill noted, was to avoid the "extremists" who desired either over-promotion of A.A. or total lack of communications with media. A "middle way" approach appears to have been most successful, Bill said.

A. A. UNITY IN SMALL COMMUNITIES

Some of the special problems involved in "carrying the message" in smaller communities were reviewed by the Conference during a panel presentation at the Thursday night session. Ruth B. of Mississippi, who chaired the meeting, reminded the Delegates that small "grass roots" groups comprised a substantial proportion of total A.A. membership and that the problems encountered by these groups were, in many respects, similar to those facing local groups in larger communities.

Ruth directed attention to the following typical "smaller community" problems:

1. Fewer A.A. meetings per week, compared with metropolitan communities.
2. Lack of variety in meetings.
3. The relatively long distance between A.A. communities.
4. Difficulty in sustaining effective sponsorship programs.
5. How to encourage a sense of personal responsibility for group survival.
6. How to revive the interest of old-timers no longer active in groups.
7. Groups with a tendency to deviate from "traditional" A.A.
8. Getting the community to direct referrals to the group.
9. The preservation of anonymity in small communities.

Fred W. (Kansas) reported that his group of 20 in a town of 18,000 persons had the support of law enforcement authorities

but had not been successful in attracting the interest of clergymen or doctors in the A.A. program.

Bob B. (Kentucky) said his small community group had recently been able to improve the effectiveness of sponsorship "follow-through" by use of a telephone answering service. The telephone operators, who have been given lists of volunteer Twelfth Steppers in the group, use a mimeographed form to record the names of the alcoholic who calls for help and the group member who has accepted the Twelfth Step assignment. These records are collected periodically by the group secretary. At group meetings, the Twelfth Step calls are then reviewed to be certain that the group is missing no opportunities to help newcomers.

Bob B. (Northern Minnesota) noted that lack of adequate communications between the small community groups in his Area had formerly been a major problem. Bob said an intensive effort to improve communications had been made with notable success during the past year.

Helen M. (South Dakota) said her group of 15 members had used editorial material from G.S.O. to correct misinformation about A.A. and to interpret the recovery program locally. Six articles have been used to date and the group will probably use new material now available from the Service Office to begin a second series in the local newspaper, Helen said.

Tape recordings can be extremely effective in giving variety to small group meetings, Ruth M. (Utah) told the Conference. Several Delegates commented that the most reliable solution for "small group" problems was for A.A.s to concentrate on "carrying the message", rather than brood about their problem.

"THE CONFERENCE — HISTORY AND FUTURE"

One of the most stirring sessions of the 1961 Conference was the Friday morning panel at which Mr. Bernard B. Smith, former chairman of the General Service Board and still an active member, joined Bill W. in a review of the early days of the conference and a forecast of some developments that may lie ahead. The meeting was chaired by Dr. John Norris, whose election as chairman of the Board was announced following the Conference.

In closing his talk, Mr. Smith recalled his address as chairman of the 1954 Conference during which he had stated his conviction that the Conference structure was essential to the survival of the Fellowship:

"We owe an obligation to society to insure that this ideal fellowship which we possess survives, that this flame of faith, this beacon light of hope for the world, must never be extinguished.

"We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery. We do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness one short block from this room. We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined to alcoholism. We need it to provide, in keeping with our Twelfth Step, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who, in the ages ahead, can find in A. A. that rebirth which brought us back to life. We need it because we, more than all others, are conscious of the devastating effect of the human urge for power and prestige which we must insure

can never invade A. A. We need it to insure A. A. against government, while insulating it against anarchy; we need it to protect A. A. against disintegration while preventing over-integration. We need it so that Alcoholics Anonymous, and Alcoholics Anonymous alone, is the ultimate depository of its Twelve Steps, its Twelve Traditions and all of its services. We need it to insure that changes within A. A. come only as a response to the needs and the wants of all A. A. and not of any few. We need it to insure that the doors of the halls of A. A. never have locks on them so that all people for all time that have an alcoholic problem may enter these halls unasked and feel welcome. We need it to insure that Alcoholics Anonymous never asks of anyone who needs us what his or her race is, what his or her creed is, what his or her social position is.

"We need it because, in the words of Pope Pius XII, 'Every people and every race which has been formed on earth today has an equal right to say, Our Father, Who art in Heaven!'"

During his portion of the presentation, Bill recalled the early struggles to establish the Conference and declared that the value of the Conference as a unifying force in A. A. had been demonstrated amply during the past decade. He referred to his current writing project dealing with "twelve concepts of service" which he emphasized was still in draft form and had not been reviewed formally by the Trustees.

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

An optimistic but realistic appraisal of the A. A. Grapevine, the Fellowship's monthly journal of interpretation and inspiration, was a feature of Friday morning's Conference session. The three-part presentation included a discussion on "The Future of the Grapevine" by Bill W., a report on the new editorial concept ("In all our affairs . . .") adopted recently and an analysis of the financial position of the magazine.

Bill said he foresaw a "brighter future and a far larger usefulness" for the Grapevine, "now a major form of communication among us and with the world around us". He said he thought it was important for the magazine to be financially secure "as an independent entity". He recalled that publication of the 25th Anniversary book, *A. A. Today*, had enabled the Grapevine to show a profit on its combined publishing operations last year and said that it might be possible for the magazine editors to have another book ready "about two years from now."

Bob B., treasurer and a director of the Grapevine, reported that there was a net profit of \$6,800 from all operations last year, traceable to a gross profit of \$17,600 from sales of *A. A. Today*. The paid circulation in 1960 was 34,524, an increase over the paid circulation of 33,858 in 1959.

To support his optimism over the financial future of the magazine, Bob noted that profit for the first three months of 1961 was \$1,500, against a loss of \$300 during the first quarter of 1960.

Gurney W., editor, struck what turned out to be one of the keynotes of the entire Conference when he said the editorial staff was now operating on the premise that "Success is a journey, not a destination".

"The best we have done before will never be good enough again", Gurney declared. He reviewed a number of steps now in work to make the Grapevine consistently more attractive and more interesting to alcoholics and their friends. He urged all Delegates to act as editorial talent scouts for the magazine in their Areas, pointing out that a disproportionately high percentage of material by qualified A. A. writers was now coming from the East and West Coasts, due to special editorial activity in those areas.

The fact that the magazine is now reaching only about nine percent of the membership (based on an estimated membership of 300,000) is a matter for concern, Gurney declared.

Helen W., managing editor, described a "Grapevine group sponsorship program" developed successfully in Ohio under which groups send a new subscription each month to outside agencies in the community or to interested non-alcoholic friends of A. A. This program was endorsed by the Conference as a whole and the Delegates established as a goal for 1961 an increase of 5,000 in the number of Grapevine subscriptions.

SPONSORSHIP

INSTITUTIONAL PROGRAMS

Active programs of sponsorship of institutional groups provide the ideal answer to any local group that feels it is getting "bored" with routine programming of meetings.

This was the message of Clarence R. (Georgia), one of the Delegate panelists of the Friday afternoon session on "Sponsorship." Trustee Pat C. (Minnesota) was chairman of the meeting.

Clarence reminded his audience that there is plenty of work to be done to help institutionalized alcoholics "and it is work that rewards both the sponsor and the community". He warned that "Traditional A. A." should be the guiding principle for such activities.

Louis S. (West Virginia) reported on an active program of hospital A. A. sponsorship in his Area. Louis has been associated with a hospital specializing in the treatment of alcoholics for the past eight years. In working with outside sponsors, he said, the hospital administrators insist that the volunteers are willing and able to follow through on sponsorship responsibilities. There is also no hesitancy in asking alcoholics: "Do you really think you have a problem" and "Would you really like to be sober?" A

sponsor is like a surgeon, Louis suggested. "An alcoholic's life may literally be in the sponsor's hands."

LONER SPONSORSHIP

All A. A.'s are basically Loners, Jack P. (Montana) pointed out. Good sponsorship of lone members consists of being willing to get out and carry the message, even when Loners live in remote locations, he emphasized. He urged Delegates who are interested in sponsoring Loners to use the A. A. Grapevine "and the telephone and correspondence" to keep in touch with lone members.

GROUP PROBLEMS

Discussing problems encountered by groups with special sponsorship programs, Frank G. (N. W. Ohio and S. E. Michigan) said it was important not to "overwhelm" a newcomer but to "expose him" to many facets of the A. A. program. "We shouldn't look down on the newcomer as a recent drunk, we should look up to him as a new man who is our link to survival," Frank declared.

LITERATURE AND TWELFTH STEP WORK

The full range of literature service provided to the groups by G. S. O.—from Bill's three basic texts to the newest pamphlet—should be considered as an extension of the Twelfth Step work that is a distinguishing characteristic of the A. A. Fellowship, George O'H. (A. A. World Services Director) declared in opening the Friday afternoon panel presentation on Literature.

Panel members were Sum C. (G. S. B. Trustee), Eve M. (G. S. O. staff), Ralph B. (G. S. O. literature consultant) and Jack W. (So. Coastal California).

Highlights of the presentation follow:

1. There is one overriding requirement for Conference-approved literature prepared at G. S. O. It must reflect "not what someone thinks the movement wants or should have, but what has actually been the sum total of our experience as a Fellowship, as we find that experience reflected in thousands of contacts each year with A. A.s in more than 80 countries."
2. While some fine literature is produced locally, it is important for the Fellowship and for our friends to know that Conference-approved literature is the only type that

can possibly represent the accumulated experience of the movement over a period of more than a quarter of a century.

3. The G. S. O. literature service is an outstanding example of the "sharing of experience" through which A. A. has grown, and can continue to grow.
4. The literature needs of the movement should be judged from the viewpoint of the newcomer and his desire for "straight answers" to his search for sobriety.
5. Conference-approved literature assures that the original A. A. message will not be garbled or destroyed.
6. No literature is ever issued from G. S. O. unless there is clear and widespread need, as reflected in requests from the groups.

As A. A. grows, the need for more—rather than less—literature will probably become apparent if A. A. is to carry its message effectively to "outsiders" with specific professional interests—and to the increasing number of groups overseas.

THE INTERNATIONAL PICTURE

One of the most inspiring and heartwarming segments of the 1961 Conference was the International presentation on Saturday morning. A major part was played in this panel discussion by A. A. members from all parts of the world who sent their tape-recorded greetings to Delegates at the Conference.

The discussion included comments by Ivan Underwood, Class A Trustee, who said that a great deal has been done in past years to take the meaning and purpose of the Fellowship to other countries where the need is as great and as urgent as at home.

While the approach to A. A. is pretty much the same throughout the world, people in the non-English speaking countries do not have the benefit of direct advice and counsel from groups in which English is regularly spoken, he said.

Stressing that the nationals of these countries must be talked to in their own language, he noted the "tremendous impact" of the recent series of articles in a French newspaper which led to the formation of that country's first all-French group.

Harold S., a loner for thirteen years in Honduras, was present at the Conference. He noted that being a loner is not difficult and said that he is no longer really alone—that he lives by the injunction to "carry our principles in all our affairs."

Hart S. who has been of great assistance to G. S. O. for the past decade in the Scandinavian translation work noted how the

translation of A. A. textbook material has spurred growth in Norway. Adrian F. emphasized that the A. A. message "should be carried by the nationals of the country in the language of the country". He also told how A. A. had been born in Holland and how its growth had been aided by sympathetic non-alcoholic friends.

Following these comments, Ann M., of the G. S. O. staff, presented tape-recorded messages from A. A. groups in Australia, Ireland, Denmark, the first French-speaking group in France and South Africa.

"Dinky", a member of the Carltonville Group of A. A. in the Transvaal, spoke of the "immense power" of "the relationship between drunk and drunk." As an example of this communication "in the language of the heart", he pointed out that a Bantu group of fifteen regular members has now been firmly established.

"The immense power of communication between drunk and drunk has in the case of the Bantu successfully crashed through the powerful barriers of language, race, tradition and prejudice and distrust and also the barrier of the master and servant relationship between white and black in this country," he said. "It is indeed a phenomenal power, in my opinion, one of the greatest powers known to man."

MONEY AND A. A. SERVICES

Six specific suggestions for generating increased support of A. A. world services were reviewed by the Delegates at the final panel presentation on "Money and A. A. Services" Saturday morning. Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, non-alcoholic Trustee, was chairman of the meeting.

Plans suggested to the Delegates, based on experience in one or more Areas, included the following:

1. The so-called "Birthday Plan" whereby members on their A. A. anniversaries, contribute one dollar for each year of sobriety, up to a fixed maximum, to support G. S. O. services. It was emphasized that this plan for individual contributions, which originated in Oklahoma, should be considered supplementary to basic group support of G. S. O. (The "Birthday Plan" was specifically approved by the Conference.)
2. Collections of 20 cents per month per member.

3. "Gratitude Box" Plan, whereby a special container is passed at group meetings to attract nickels, dimes and quarters.
4. The "Percentage" Plan. "Take a percentage of group funds equal to 25 cents per member per month and send it to G. S. O."
- a. The "Tap" Plan. "Tap collection plate at each meeting for an amount equal to total number of members per year, divided into sum of \$3 per member."
6. The "Fat Kitty" Plan. "Groups that already have a prudent reserve can start off by paying on a monthly basis, using the \$3 per member yardstick."

As little as a five per cent increase in the number of groups contributing to support A. A. world service can mean an additional \$17,000 to help carry the message to alcoholics, one Delegate suggested.

HIGHLIGHTS FROM THE AREAS

An innovation in programming at the 1961 Conference was the scheduling of approximately 40 three-minute reports by Delegates on developments or problems in their Areas that they felt might be of interest to the entire meeting. The time schedule was enforced strictly.

Although not all Delegates were able to report significant trends or events, the overall effect of the "Highlights from the Areas" reports was to disclose an active, growing movement in which most members are confronting changing problems with enthusiasm and good humor.

Capsule digests of the reports follow:

Weldon L. (Southeastern Texas)—Pointed up progress made in Area toward gaining new friends among officials of prisons and institutions. Said that local hospitals are beginning to permit self-commitment for alcoholics, provided they have an A.A. sponsor.

Ruth M. (Utah)—Emphasized the necessity of making scheduled meetings at institutions and reported on the progressive attitude of officials toward A.A. in Utah.

"Hap" T. (Hawaii)—Noted that the number of groups in Hawaii has increased sharply in past year. Said that prison groups and half-way house are now off to a good start. Also pointed out that public information committee is now getting under way.

Mauritz K. (Wyoming)—pointed out that distance is a problem in Wyoming and stressed the help that one group gives to another in his Area. Also noted that institutional work is regarded as an increasingly important phase of Twelfth Step work in Wyoming.

Ted R. (Eastern Pennsylvania)—Noted that Area has problems, but said that "they can be handled." Groups share their experience, not only in recovery, but in service and unity problems. Area meetings have helped to make groups in Area conscious of G. S. O.

George G. (Chicago)—Pointed up large measure of success that groups have been having in establishing institutional meetings. Said that Chicago now has a treatment center to handle 72 alcoholics, and expansion is being planned.

Warren H. (Central & Southwest Ohio)—Noted that recent public information activities in Area had resulted in series of radio and TV programs, and newspaper stories. "They brought new respect and understanding to A.A." Also helped bring in new members.

Al B. (Eastern Ontario)—Reported adoption of General Service panels in Area which have sparked increased acceptance of G. S. O. concept. Also noted success of educational program and attendance of exchange students and members of outside agencies at annual conferences.

Jules P. (Southern California)—Have been "talking G. S. O." at the group level with good results thus far. Membership and contributions up. Pushing idea of contributions at the rate of "six cents per member per week, with two weeks off for good behavior."

Vince S. (Southern Minnesota)—Reported increasing success with educational program. Sending A.A. members with "high quality of sobriety" to speak to doctors, ministers and others." There is still much work to do."

Frank R. (Eastern Massachusetts)—Increasing effort to contact G. S. R.'s. At a recent meeting, however, there were only 36 out of 165 groups represented. Seeking to correct this situation by

sending out questionnaire and issuing bulletin. "Going all out to meet responsibilities."

J. C. McL. (Alabama)—Held an increased number of Area meetings last year with the result that support for world services was sharply increased. Also report new impetus for educational programs in Area, with many new friends among officials of hospitals and institutions.

John M. (Southern Wisconsin)—Pointed out that he has come to believe that it is his duty to go back to his Area with the story of world service. Thinks it is very important that he come up with some new way to get "Third Legacy thinking" across to General Service Representatives.

Jo W. (British Columbia and Yukon Territory)—Noted that it is "quite a job" to get to all the districts in her Area. They are covered, however, by car, plane and—when necessary—by dog team. Have set up a tape library in the Area to tell the Third Legacy story.

Leon P. (Western Missouri)—Third Legacy program running smoothly now. Noted that members in his Area are especially proud of the fact that two Air Force Bases have fully accepted A.A. Base commanders and medical men now refer problem drinkers to groups in the Area.

Jack J. (Arizona)—Noted that A.A. groups in his area "strayed" from the Third Legacy "in order to avoid politics." Delegates to General Service Conference picked by drawing names out of a hat. Result: communications system badly damaged. Have made progress in getting back in touch since then.

Fred V. (Southeastern New York)—Noted that the Area's proximity to the General Service Office and the very strong Intergroup office in New York City have led to apathy on part of members. Corrected by holding sixteen area meetings in 1960 and also put out newsletters to G. S. R.'s in order to stimulate interest.

G. D. S. (Arkansas)—Reported that A.A.s have settled down to the "primary-purpose phase" in his Area and embarked on campaign to educate general public. Trying to establish effective contacts with doctors, lawyers and ministry without violating the Traditions.

Ruth D. (Virginia)—Sign of progress in her Area that there is no "active" opposition to G. S. O. concept. The fact that there is no positive feeling in some Areas is being remedied by information meetings in the Area at regular intervals.

Ed. E. (Iowa)—Have realized the necessity of having "some organization" in order to maintain communications with other groups in Area and in the nation. Lines of communication set up at Eastern and Western State conferences, with G. S. O. information passed out at Area committee meetings.

Bob H. (Colorado)—Noted the difficulty of getting A.A. started in any area without the help of members who are able to share their experience, strength and hope with the newcomer. Pointed out that this is the function today of G. S. O. in many areas and that members should be reminded of this.

John K. (Connecticut)—Noted that members in his Area are increasingly appreciative of the work done by G. S. O. Contributions have been increased in the past two years and the state will do its part from now on. Mentioned better understanding from medical men, police officials and others who work with A. A.

HIGHLIGHTS FROM THE AREAS

Norman S. (Northern Florida)—Pointed out that his state has made "great progress" in understanding alcoholism, as shown by the invitation of the Governor for A. A. to hold its 1965 convention at Miami. Noted success of educational program undertaken by members and many new friends of A. A.

Marie S. (Downstate Illinois)—Noted that there have been problems in her area, but that "dissension is part of growing up". Pointed out that members are working to stimulate new interest among older members. This is a "disturbing" problem, but they are making headway.

Hugh C. (Washington, D. C.)—Discussed points of friction between local groups and outside agencies that have been solved to everyone's satisfaction by sitting down and talking them out. Not only are problems solved, but new understanding is to advantage of all.

Watt L. (Louisiana)—Glad to hear other Delegates discuss problems and solutions. Knew that he would have some concrete answers to take back to his area and is convinced that G. S. O. will continue to play a major part in the activities of groups throughout the country and the world.

Herman P. (Easten Missouri)—Discussed problems, but noted many "good things" that signify progress in his Area. A women's prison has A. A. meetings for the first time, and plans are being made for a Twelve Step House for women. An increasing number of hospitals are designating separate facilities for alcoholics.

Wayne G. (Indiana)—Noted that groups in his area are increasingly aware of responsibilities to G. S. O. and said that interest is stimulated by area meetings and information panels.

Bourke O'B. (Northern New Jersey)—Trouble in getting good G. S. R.'s from some groups. But this is being alleviated by making special effort to get "live wires". Noted, too, that co-operation between G. S. R.'s and Area intergroup office gets better each year.

Reece H. (Northeastern Texas)—Remarked that problems have arisen regarding acceptance of G. S. O. concept, but that this has been solved in some measure by holding Area meetings throughout District. Finds that support is increasing as time goes on.

George P. (Western Pennsylvania)—Noted that spiritual leaders of all faiths have come to accept A. A. in his Area. Also said that interest in G. S. R. meetings has been sparked by sending out double-fold post cards. Attendance at Area meetings now up to 80 per cent.

Bob R. (Oklahoma)—Said that members once regarded G. S. R. duties as a chore, but through education and Area meetings now regard it as a privilege to serve. "Better relations with authorities have resulted in a good many institutional meetings in area."

Anne C. (Northeast Ohio)—Area overcoming apathy to General Service through educational program at the grass roots level. "G. S. O. support is necessary for the survival of A. A." Hold Area meetings in an increased number of districts. Increasing number of people in Area now appreciate that Dr. Bob's admonition to "keep it simple" referred to the recovery program itself and was not intended to disparage the structure essential to carry the message to alcoholics.

Bob K. (Northwestern Texas)—General Service problems have been worked out gradually with "a little time, effort and understanding." Have state commission on alcoholism and alcoholic counselors at many institutions, as well as separate wards at many hospitals. Still room for much improvement.

J. A. N. (North Carolina)—Noted encouraging work with prison groups. Now nineteen correctional institutions with weekly meetings. Plans being made for 300-bed hospital which will get those convicted on public intoxication charges. Pointed out that North Carolina was one of first to have educational program at state level.

Bill G. (Central New York)—Noted difficulty of getting speakers for institutional meetings, but said this is being corrected through special efforts. Pointed out that doctors in Area have begun to take active interest in program and attend large Area meetings.

Alvin T. (Central Michigan)—Noted that "individual survival depends on group's survival and that group survival depends on A. A. unity." Have stressed that theme in Area to find new support and greater understanding for G. S. O.

Dick W. (Nevada)—Pointed out that contact with G. S. O. has meant survival for a great many individuals in his Area.

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

(Anita Ryan, Secretary)

Each year understanding and interest in our Third Legacy of Service includes more A. A. groups and individual members. Area General Service Committees are increasingly active, and the interest of G. S. R.s is improving. More groups are recognizing the importance of electing qualified members to serve as their connecting link with Area Committees and G. S. O.

The number of Committee Members receiving G. S. O. Conference mailings has increased to 878. And this year we have 84 Delegates to the General Service Conference. For the first time, we are happy to welcome a Delegate from the State of Hawaii. The request for an additional Delegate from the Province of Ontario will receive further consideration by the Admissions Committee this year after review of Bill's memorandum on "New Delegates".

The Board of Trustees and Admissions Committee approved inviting officially named A. A. representatives of foreign countries where A. A. is operating to participate in the General Service Conference. These overseas representatives will have the privilege of the floor but no vote. Responsibility for their expenses will not be assumed by the General Service Board and Conference.

As suggested at the 1960 Conference, a question and answer section has been added to the Third Legacy Manual. It is also available as a separate pamphlet, and many Delegates and Committee Members have requested copies for distribution. Letters have indicated that the supplement is a helpful tool.

A plan was approved by the 1960 Conference whereby, on request, G. S. R.s whose names have been validated by their Area Committees may receive duplicates of mailings sent to the group address. Over 1000 have been placed on this mailing list. It has been helpful and effective in some areas, and we hope these mailings can be continued. However, we are suggesting the use of a form to be filled in and signed by the G. S. R. to avoid duplicate mailings to one address and to save the time necessary for checking the lists.

We are grateful for the progress that has been made through the efforts of our Delegates and Committee Members in carrying the message of service. There are still some areas where a great deal of work is necessary to increase knowledge and interest in the General Service Conference and the relationship of each A. A. to it.

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

(H. Sumner Campbell, Secretary)

The Board of Trustees meets four times a year, on the last Monday in April, July, October and January. The annual meeting is held in April (following the meeting of the General Service Conference) when all Trustees are elected for one year terms.

Reports and recommendations are made at quarterly meetings by the Board's committees: Finance & Budgetary, Literature, Nominating, Policy, Public Information, (a subcommittee of the Policy Committee) and its two wholly-owned corporations: A. A. World Services, Inc. and A. A. Grapevine, Inc.

The Board, its committees and corporations make annual reports to the General Service Conference in April. In addition, Interim Reports of all major actions are sent to Conference Area Delegates and Committeemen in September and December. During the past year, the Board . . .

Authorized the Public Information Committee to provide film coverage of the 25th Anniversary Convention in Long Beach, California.

Granted an Emeritus Trusteeship to Mr. Frank Gulden and to Mr. Leonard Strong in view of their years of devoted service as non-A. A. Trustees. (Mr. Gulden passed away in January, five months after he had been given Emeritus status).

Authorized the use of 300,000 as the estimated number of men and women in A. A.

Negotiated a contract with the A. A. Service and Information Committee of South Africa for the publication of a composite book in Afrikaans. It is to be a combined work containing portions of "Alcoholics Anonymous," "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" and "A. A. Comes of Age," similar to the Norwegian A. A. Book.

Recommended to the Conference Committee on Admissions that officially named A. A. representatives of foreign countries, where A. A. is operating, be invited to participate in the General Service Conference as Corresponding Members, with the privilege of the floor

but without vote, and that the General Service Board and Conference assume no financial responsibility for the expenses of such representatives . . .

Approved the Public Information Committee's statement on "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping People Informed." (This establishes a program within A. A. Tradition to supply factual information to interested and responsible media where they might be expected to help "carry the message.")

Spread upon the minutes of the October quarterly meeting a resolution in tribute to Hank Grieme who died October 26, 1960, in Ireland while attending to A. A. affairs. Approved an outright gift of \$3,000 from General Fund to Mrs. Henry F. Grieme as an expression of deep gratitude for Hank's extraordinary service in behalf of A. A.

Appointed Herb Morse to be manager of General Services, the post left vacant by Hank's sudden death. Approved the withdrawal of \$25,000 from the Reserve Fund for transfer to the Group Fund account against the deficit in the latter.

Did not approve the request (a resolution presented to the 1960 Conference by the Delegate from the Southern California-L. A. Area) for permanent representation on the General Service Board of two Trustees from west of the Rocky Mountains, but referred the matter to the Board's Policy Committee for further study.

Referred back to the Conference Committee on Admissions, with a memorandum from Bill, the request for an additional Area Delegate from Ontario.

Agreed to advise the Conference that, in connection with plans for a 1965 A. A. Convention, it will be glad to receive invitations from possible convention cities, and that it reserves for itself the responsibility of establishing financial requirements and appraising other factors affecting the holding of such a convention.

GROUP RELATIONS AND GROUP SERVICES

(Lyb Symington)

The A. A. General Service Office today serves more than 8,500 groups throughout the world. Through correspondence, and by talking with visitors, the G. S. O. Staff keeps in touch with groups in all stages of development, from those just starting to group No. 1, now almost 26 years old.

In 1960, the G. S. O. Staff answered more than 37,000 letters, acknowledged more than 8,000 contributions, and welcomed more than 1,300 visitors to G. S. O. Weekly meetings provide an opportunity for the staff to discuss answers to questions and improvements in services.

Many letters were received last year from group officers and individual members requesting answers to problems that had arisen in their groups or areas. Each letter was answered by a staff member in terms of what A. A. world-wide group experience has been. Some of these questions were:

1. Should a group buy literature only from G. S. O. and, if so, why?
2. We have a member who has enjoyed sobriety for a number of years but refuses to turn over the job of group Secretary to someone else. Would it be all right for some of us to form a new group and have the Secretary rotate every three months?
3. What do other groups do about a member who hasn't taken a drink, but is "slipping" on pills? Is he allowed to celebrate his anniversary?
4. We want to form an Intergroup Committee to handle 12th step calls for groups in our county. Can you tell us how to set up a telephone answering service?
5. The groups in our city are holding a State Convention for the first time. Can you recommend some speakers and tell us how to go about setting up the program and financing it?
6. We are a tri-city group—that is, three small groups in towns about 30 miles apart. Can you tell us whether it would be better to hold our weekly meeting in a central location, or rotate it from town to town?
7. The F. B. I. circularized the groups in our state and asked us to notify them if a certain alcoholic showed up at our meetings. How can we break another member's anonymity?
8. Our group has a tape recorder and would like tapes of A. A. talks. Where can we get some?
9. Are individual donations to an A. A. group exempt from Federal Income Tax?
10. We would like to hold special meetings for newcomers. Can you send us some suggestions?

The pamphlets, "Partners in A. A.," and A. A. Tradition—How It Developed," are often enclosed with letters answering such questions. Other special material, based on our collective experience, includes:

"Suggestions for Intergroup or Central Offices"
"Suggestions for Local Conferences, Conventions
and Area Get-Togethers"

"For a Group on an Armed Forces Base" and "List of Groups and Loners on Armed Forces Bases Worldwide"

This material, when appropriate, is also enclosed.

Services To Groups

1. Free literature samples and a copy of the A. A. World Directory are sent to each new group when it registers with G. S. O. In 1960, 1,133 groups received this service.
2. A. A. staff members made 31 trips, coast to coast, to attend Anniversary Banquets and A. A. State and Regional Conventions during 1960.
3. A 16mm film of the TV show, "Days of Wine & Roses," was loaned to groups in Canada. It has been shown in

British Columbia, Alberta, Manitoba, Saskatchewan, Quebec and Ontario, and is scheduled to go to the Atlantic Provinces in May.

4. Tapes of two *Catholic Hour* radio programs were loaned to more than 60 groups in the past year.

A. A. Exchange Bulletin

Monthly mailings of 14,000 copies of the Bulletin are being made to A. A. Groups, Intergroups, Loners Internationalists, G. S. R.'s and Conference Area Committees. This is an increase of 2,000 a month, since January, 1960. Starting with the October, 1960, issue, pictures are now being used in the A. A. Exchange Bulletin.

Use and Misuse of A. A. World Directory

The 1959 Conference discussed the use and misuse of the A. A. World Directory and the Conference Policy Committee recommended that "In regard to A. A. misuse of the Directory, the attention of groups again be directed to its purpose, as listed on inside cover of Directory. That this be used as a guide and not a rule, as it is not intended to interfere with free communication among A. A.'s in sharing experiences and activities. That non-A. A. misuse be handled as in the past."

The statement on the inside of the Directory cover is: "It is not to be used as a mailing list for any form of solicitation or any commercial venture."

Interpretation of these two statements has sometimes been difficult, for in some cases they seem to contradict each other. Therefore, a review of specific cases of Directory misuse during the past four years is presented with the hope that this Conference may be able to advise whether the types of material offered for sale would, or would not, fall within the Directory purpose of "free communication among A. A.'s in sharing experiences and activities." (Most of the cases involved use of only a portion of the Directory.)

Item For Sale

1. "Lessons" for A. A.'s Mimeograph material.
2. Books on Alcoholism and posters for teaching.
3. Pamphlets and cards with inspirational items and prayers, as well as several booklets which tell how to run an A. A. discussion meeting.
4. A. A. Anniversary cards.
5. Coin with Serenity Prayer, a pocket piece.
6. A. A. lighter—for anniversary gift.
7. Card for newcomer—slot for coin and place for phone number.
8. Decalcomania for car. (Camel & two pyramids which form A. A.)

Comment

G. S. O. was unable to find out who operated this venture. A "blind" address was used. Printed by an individual A. A. for lectures on alcoholism.

Several A. A. members run such nonprofit companies, selling items just above cost. They use profit, if any, to send free literature to Institutional groups and lone members. One A. A. group sells pamphlets.

Company owned and operated by an A. A. member.

Company owned by A. A. member who sells to groups in his area.

This is a venture of an A. A. member who sells them to groups in his state.

Sold by an individual A. A. to groups in his state

Sold by A. A. member to members in his area so they can identify each other's cars.

Parts of the Directory were used to solicit business for two alcoholic rest homes. Both managers were members of A. A. One club for A. A. members used the Directory to solicit funds for the club.

OVERSEAS A. A. AND INTERNATIONALISTS

Overseas Groups _____ 1,112

Overseas Members _____ 17,737

(Ann Macfarlane)

France

An active group of about 30 French A. A.s began to meet regularly in Paris for the first time during 1960. This significant development in A. A. growth overseas can be traced to the interest of Joseph Kessel, noted newspaperman and novelist, who learned of A. A. through the recovery of a friend. During a visit to New York, Mr. Kessel visited G. S. O., obtained additional information on the movement and was introduced to many members and groups in the New York area.

A resulting series of 20 articles published in *France Soir*, a leading French daily, led to the existing English-speaking group in Paris being deluged with inquiries in French. G. S. O., with the assistance of the Montreal Central Office and the Quebec Provincial Service Committee, supplied substantial A. A. literature in French. In Paris, a bilingual secretary was found, to handle correspondence, and the group began to grow. Legal formalities covering the registration of societies of this type in Paris were worked out with the assistance of Mr. Ivan Underwood, non-alcoholic Trustee of the General Service Board, Nick H. of the Paris group and an interested non-alcoholic. The required fees were paid by G. S. O.

The possibility of arranging publication of a French "combined abridged edition" of the three major A. A. texts is being explored. The Kessel articles, meanwhile, have appeared in book form under the title "Avec Les Alcooliques Anonymes" and continue to increase understanding of the movement in France.

Latin America

The December issue of the Reader's Digest in Spanish carried an article by Paul de Kruif, "The Mysterious Medicine of Alcoholics Anonymous," listing the G. S. O. address. Since then, inquiries have been reaching the office daily. Approximately 250 have been processed so far with the help of the Grupo D. F. in Mexico City and the Buenos Aires Group in Argentina. Each inquirer has received literature in Spanish and a letter. Those interested have also been put on the mailing list to receive the *Gaceta del Alcoholico*, a publication of the Grupo D. F. To further help the rapidly growing Spanish-speaking groups and Loners, now numbering 108 and 16 respectively, that are registered with G. S. O., a Spanish Newsletter is going out monthly, beginning with the April Exchange Bulletin mailing. A member of the Mexico City Group is helping us with the translation.

Japan

A visit to G. S. O. from Dr. Masao Taketani of the Osaka Mental Hygiene Clinic, will help to carry the message in Japan. Through the help of interpreters supplied by G. S. O., Dr. Taketani was able to talk with Bill and others at the office and to attend meetings in the New York area. He returned to Osaka with the intention of finding a translator for G. S. O. literature so that the Japanese alcoholic could be reached. His experience at the Osaka Clinic has convinced him that A. A. may be the answer for many Japanese alcoholics that have been treated unsuccessfully to date. A recent letter from Dr. Taketani expressed eagerness to get started on the translations with the help of alcoholics in Osaka. A similar visit from Professor Aiji Takechi of Kwansai Gakuin University in Nishinomiya and Mr. Bufo Yamamuro of the Japanese Temperance Union provided additional information about A. A. to Japanese nationals.

Union of South Africa

The combined abridged edition of our three books is shortly to be available in Afrikaans. G. S. O. shared the experience gained through working on the Norwegian abridged edition and offered financial help to be rebated in proportion to the amount

of the subsidy, though a greater part of the money had already been raised in South Africa.

Transvaal

A mimeographed booklet of A. A. material translated into Isixhosa is now available and plans for further translations into other native dialects have been undertaken by Anton S. of the Carletonville Group.

Material in Swahili is also available through the cooperation of Dick C. of Robeson, Pennsylvania.

Denmark

Two articles about A. A. in *Alt For Damerne*, a Danish women's magazine published in Copenhagen, have brought about an increased understanding and growth of A. A. in Copenhagen.

New Zealand

A report from Wellington indicates that an A. A. Service Council of New Zealand is in the making, similar to the already-formed Service Council of Australia.

India

From the visit of one of our travelling members, the need for literature in Hindi and possibly other Indian dialects has been noted. One of our Loners in Lucknow is anxious to help in this venture and an exploration of the problems and possibilities involved is now under way.

Possibilities For Further Service

The following possibilities for additional G. S. O. service to overseas groups should be noted:

(1) *Preparation of articles and material that could be used, if desired, by overseas newletters, bulletins and magazines.* Stories and specific examples of traditional service functions, i.e., "How A Service Center Works," "How an Institutional Committee Functions," and similar informative topics. The objective would be to interpret our Traditions to newly formed groups so that they can be helped to prevent some of the problems that arise when Traditions are not understood or appreciated. Since local newsletters and magazines frequently request contributions, these articles might prove a welcome source of material.

(2) *Preparation of tapes to be used at meetings of small groups overseas.* The use of tapes is becoming more and more widespread. There is a great demand for them and they could prove a valuable tool in helping overseas groups to become established within the traditional framework of A. A.

(3) *Financial help to establish A. A. in some areas where the average alcoholic cannot afford pamphlet literature and books scaled at U. S. A. prices.* If offered judiciously and only when the need is apparent, such aid could help to avoid an existing situation where it has been felt necessary by local A. A.s to accept outside financial help to provide literature and an office.

Internationalists

The roster of Internationalists (A. A. seamen) now stands at 250. All have been receiving bi-monthly Bulletins consisting of excerpts from their own letters to G. S. O. Internationalists are among our best travelling ambassadors, spreading the A. A. message wherever they may be and helping and encouraging many newly-formed groups overseas. Visits to G. S. O., letters and mail contact with other Internationalist members all help. An up-to-date directory of members is maintained, with ship addresses indicated whenever possible, so that contacts between Internationalists, as well as with G. S. O., can be kept up.

INSTITUTIONAL A. A. (Correctional Facilities and Hospitals)

(Eve Marsh)

Since 1952, when services for institutional groups were started at G. S. O., it has become apparent that the success of all groups in hospitals and correctional facilities depends equally on the cooperation of the authorities and of A. A. itself. We have seen constantly increasing evidence of the interest and cooperation of hospital and prison administrators. In fact, what they have said about A. A. has made it possible to share their opinions with other administrators in a special pamphlet available at G. S. O.

During the past year G. S. O. instituted a survey of the many groups in prisons and hospitals to ascertain the kind of cooperation they are receiving from the A. A. groups. It is encouraging to report that only five percent of all such groups report no cooperation from A. A. in their areas. Ten percent still rely on the one individual who brings the same message each week, and ten percent rely on one group. But seventy-five percent are either served by several groups, or by an Institutional Committee formed by the groups in the area.

The growth of Institutional Committees has been a good indication of the responsibility A. A. is taking for the inmate or patient who has to rely upon A. A. members to bring him the message of recovery and assure the welcome granted him or her when he is discharged and can approach a regular group.

The 1961 Directories of A. A. groups in Correctional Facilities and Hospitals listed the following totals: 435 groups in correctional facilities, 360 groups in hospitals, 34 Institutional Committees and 6 Sponsorship Committees. Total membership in these groups approaches a total of 25,000.

Service to Institutional Groups is of course based on "sharing experiences:"

1. Hospital and Prison Directories are compiled annually. These show publications issued by various groups, list special tape recordings that are available from groups and outline the restrictions and privileges covering correspondence.

2. Complimentary literature is distributed to all new groups.
3. Two special literature packages are made available at reduced rates. (The basic package representing \$4.50 worth of literature is sold for \$3.00. The basic package, plus a one-year subscription to *The A. A. Grapevine*, is sold for \$6.00).
4. The "A. A. Exchange Bulletin" is distributed to all Institutional Groups regularly.
5. G. S. O. makes available to individual Prison and Hospital Groups, through personal correspondence, the experience of other groups in solving specific problems.
6. "A. A." groups are encouraged to undertake sponsorship of institutional A. A. programs, directly or through area Institutional Committees.
7. G. S. O. corresponds with Institutional Administrators and staff personnel who have expressed interest in the A. A. program. Without the understanding and support of these friends of A. A., few groups could be effective.
8. In addition to the material quoting penologists and Hospital Administrators, we have a new pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate". This should be an extremely helpful tool for Institutional Committees and groups in correctional facilities. Many inmate members helped in its compilation.

The need for literature speakers and sponsorship for groups unable to provide these services for themselves is great. It is good to see the way in which individual A. A.s and A. A. groups are assuming this responsibility. The growth of Institutional Committees reflects this, insuring literature, meetings, sponsorship and a welcome in an A. A. group upon discharge or release.

Institutional administrators are most cooperative in granting privileges unheard of in penal history. For example, one G. S. R. of a group in a correctional facility was allowed to attend the Area Assembly meeting held in a nearby town.

G. S. B. LITERATURE COMMITTEE

(H. Sumner Campbell, Chairman)

The new pamphlet, "Memo to an Inmate Who May be an Alcoholic," was published in February, 1961, following approval by the Literature Committees of the Board and Conference. It is based upon information and material provided by Institutional groups and area Institutional Committees. Officials of correctional institutions and other friends in the correctional field reviewed the final draft and made a number of favorable comments.

Both the 1959 and 1960 Conferences approved the concept of a pamphlet to advise clergymen of A. A.'s sole purpose and how they can help the alcoholic find sobriety in A. A. A draft of this pamphlet, now titled "A Clergyman asks about Alcoholics Anonymous," has been approved by the Board and Conference Literature Committees, and has been sent to a select list of clergymen for their comments.

Revision of the 25th Anniversary leaflet (containing general information about A. A. for non-alcoholics) was undertaken at the Public Information Committee. It is now available through A. A. World Services.

A description of the General Service Office of A. A. was approved by both Literature Committees and it is included in Conference Members' portfolios.

Production is now in progress on revision of the following

three pamphlets: "Young People and A. A.," "The Alcoholic Employee" and "Cooperation—Yes: Affiliation—No."

During the past year the Board's Literature Committee and the G. S. O. Staff have given considerable thought and study to the long-range need for literature in languages other than English. Authorization was given to A. A. World Service to publish the following Spanish pamphlets (six are translations by the A. A. group in Buenos Aires, and one is the gift of a member of the General Service Board):

- "This is A. A."
- "The Alcoholic Husband"
- "A. A. and the Medical Profession"
- "Is A. A. For You?"
- "Alcoholism the Illness"
- "A Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" (reprint from *Good Housekeeping* magazine)

Reprint of the 1941 *Saturday Evening Post* article on A. A.

Negotiations are underway with an A. A. member in France for a translation of a composite A. A. book, to include parts of "Alcoholics Anonymous," "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," and "A. A. Comes of Age." The possibility of a Spanish translation of this same material is under study.

G. S. B. PUBLIC INFORMATION COMMITTEE

(Allan Bachman, Chairman)

The Public Information Committee was formed in January, 1956 as a subcommittee of the Policy Committee, to act in an advisory capacity to the General Service Office. The Committee was created to fill a need for a broader sharing of responsibility in sustaining A. A.'s sound movement-wide public relations which are directed toward improving public *understanding* of our program while preventing *misunderstanding* of our Fellowship.

In fulfillment of these objectives, the Committee has always invited the press and other communications media to take advantage of A. A.'s "open door" policy. In all public information matters which it may consider, the Committee's actions are subject to approval by the Policy Committee and the Trustees. The Committee is also bound to adhere to the traditional A. A. policy of "attraction rather than promotion" in all public relations.

For the past two years, the Committee has functioned as a working group in guiding and encouraging editorial recognition of our 25th Anniversary Year and, more recently, in meeting new and increased demands for service which are a natural consequence of the Anniversary activity. The Committee holds regular monthly meetings and individual members of the Committee consult with G. S. O. staff members whenever necessary.

As one consequence of the 25th Anniversary public information program, many new and old friends with communications media have asked the General Service Office to place them on our mailing list in order that they could be kept informed of matters relating to the movement in the future. As a logical development of A. A.'s long-standing policy of inviting the press and other communications media to take advantage of our "open door" policy, the Board of Trustees, at its October meeting, authorized the Public Information Committee to establish a mailing list of those who have asked to be sent releases containing factual news and information about A. A. This authorization was included in a policy statement entitled "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping People Informed," which also set forth rigid controls to be observed by the Committee in determining how and when a release can properly be issued.

A mailing list has been compiled including magazines, newspapers, wire services, feature syndicates, editorial page writers, columnists, and radio and TV directors, producers and commentators, among others. The first release will summarize our annual reports to the membership as submitted to the delegates at the 1961 Conference. The release will, in effect, constitute our first annual report to the public about A. A. world-wide. It will, we believe, go far to dispel the misconception of A. A. as a secret society which still exists in many areas.

Local Committees

Largely as a result of their participation in an Advertising Council project and other activities in connection with the 25th Anniversary, many groups and Central Offices have considered it advisable to establish their own public information committees, functioning at local or area levels. Soon after the Long Beach Conference, the Public Information Committee began to establish communications with the local committees, of which we now have record of 48. We have sent them copies of the "Responsibilities of the Movement" statement and other information about our activities.

Following an international survey of A. A. experience, the Public Information Committee has recently compiled and pub-

lished a file of information for speakers under the title, "Speaking at Non-A. A. Meetings."

The Committee has up-dated, revised and expanded the "pattern" newspaper stories and radio-television script material that has been used effectively by hundreds of local groups in the past.

The four-page leaflet, "Background Information on the 25th Anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous," has also been updated and revised so that it is now a general rather than a special-purpose piece. Re-titled, "Background Information on Alcoholics Anonymous," the leaflet is used constantly by the staff as a convenient means of answering inquiries about the Fellowship.

Anonymity Mailing

It has been customary to make a mailing explaining A. A.'s tradition of anonymity to a large list of communications media every three years. The last mailing was in 1958. Work is now in process on another mass mailing. Because of special problems involving A. A. anonymity on television, the Television Code Review Board of the National Association of Broadcasters has offered to include a statement on the subject in its official bulletin.

The Public Information Committee has also participated in meetings with certain organizations outside A. A. who are concerned with the problem of alcoholism. In January, the Committee and G. S. O. staff met with the Executive Committee of North American Association for Alcoholic Programs. It was an informal get-together intended to create a better mutual understanding of our respective functions, to establish improved communications between our offices, and to explore possible conflicts between A. A. and the official agencies with a view to eliminating the causes of any such conflicts which may now exist or which may arise in the future. Similar informal meetings were held in October and January with officers and staff of the National Council on Alcoholism. The results of these three meetings have been reported to the Study Committee on A. A.'s Relations with Outside Agencies and will be presented as a part of that Committee's report to the Conference.

The Board of Trustees has given the Public Information Committee the responsibility for conducting any future meetings which may be requested by these or other organizations which function in the field of Alcoholism outside A. A.

Motion Pictures

Members of the Committee have had several discussions with the representative of a motion picture company which has expressed interest in producing a feature film, "The Story of Alcoholics Anonymous." However, it would be difficult to film a history of A. A. in which Bill W. would not be portrayed in a very prominent role. Bill believes that such treatment would be unacceptable in view of his stated convictions concerning his personal anonymity and his refusal to accept public honors for A. A. work. The Committee has suggested that the producer consider the possibility of some alternative treatment such as a dramatic, inspirational treatment of the A. A. "recovery story."

Three producers of commercial films have approached the General Service Office regarding an A. A. service film. The Committee has not followed up on these approaches to date.

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

(Directors, Editor and Staff Report)

During 1960 the Grapevine's three-year re-organization plan was completed and Bill submitted a final report which was adopted by the Trustees, and GV Corporate Board last September. (Bill's report has been sent under separate cover to the Delegates.)

By January 1961 the Editorial Department was able to announce a new editorial policy defined as "In All Our Affairs." Previous soundings by the Editorial Staff had discovered a new "pool" of A. A. writers who were eager to contribute under this editorial concept which gave a wider scope to their talents. The results of this new dimension of GV have been increasingly apparent since January in the volume of encouraging mail and in the increase of sales and subscriptions. The quality of our unsolicited manuscripts has also taken a decided upswing as contributors discovered they were no longer confined to the oversimplified "meeting in print" Grapevine which had been the former policy.

The Grapevine cover was recently redesigned by our artists and editors to create a more consistent image of the magazine. Only the color and the decorative design will now be altered with each issue. The Grapevine format has also been changed to accord with the "In All Our Affairs" principle. This cover change begins with the May issue.

Our Editorial Board of volunteers has been of immense help in all phases of these Grapevine improvements. Several new A.

A. writers and artists of long professional experience have been added in the past year.

The Editorial Staff continues to be responsible for all Grapevine promotion. This has been kept "low-keyed" as suggested by the 1960 General Service Conference. Here are highlights of our 1960 promotion:

1. Three flyers were sent out to the readers in 1960-1961.
 - a) The October International Issue
 - b) The Christmas Bonus flyer
 - c) Announcement of the two new series "In All Our Affairs," by Bill; "The Twelve Steps Revisited," by Jerry E.
2. Grapevine display material and literature was supplied to all conferences and conventions when requested.
3. Twenty-eight states and six Canadian provinces now follow the new "Grapevine Representative Plan" and have been responsible for 923 new subscriptions and the sale of 419 copies of *A. A. Today*.
4. The just announced program, suggested by Al Lackey, former delegate from Northeast Ohio, which is called "The Grapevine Group Sponsorship Plan," described in the April GV, is beginning to attract considerable group attention and will be discussed at the coming GV Conference session.

Financial Comparison: 1960 vs. 1959

(By Dick Stevens - Chairman)

Our accountant reports that The A. A. Grapevine (excluding profits of \$17,000 on *A. A. Today*) lost \$10,800 in 1960, compared with \$753 for 1959.

From the normal operational viewpoint, these figures do not, however, make an understandable comparison with the year 1959. During 1960 our non-recurring expense was very heavy. For example: severance pay for two staff members—\$5,980; moving expenses—\$1,200; and \$400 in extra telephone calls on *A. A. Today*. We also paid the two retiring staff members \$2,390—a 15% cost of living increase from January 1960 to December 1960. While this sum is not, technically speaking, a non-recurring figure, this item, nevertheless, did not exist in 1959, and will not exist in 1961. It is removed so as to make a clearer comparison between 1960 and 1959 possible.

Subtracting the above items from our reported loss of \$10,800 would reduce this figure to a nominal amount.

Since last year we have effected still more economies. While

our accountant will be unable to give the Conference a report on the first quarter of 1961, it seems probable that the GV will earn \$2,000 in magazine net profit during this period, to which will be added about \$1,000 net from the continuing sale of *A. A. Today*. All told, the first quarter of 1961 may prove to be one of the best ever for the Grapevine.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION:

1. The net GV circulation in 1960 increased 666 over 1959.
2. April 1961, shows net circulation increase of 878 over January 1, 1961.
3. Renewal rate, higher than average commercial magazines, is holding at 72½%.
4. New printing contract already signed, will save \$2,500 yearly, beginning in June, 1961.
5. Consolidated statement of GV plus *A. A. Today* shows net profit of \$6,841 for 1960.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD POLICY COMMITTEE

(John Park Lee, Secretary)

The Policy Committee has the responsibility of advising the General Service Board on matters closely related to the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions, and to the general welfare of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Customarily the Committee meets three times a year on the Sundays before the General Service Board meetings in July, October and January. Because a severe snow storm cancelled the January meeting, the Committee met only twice during the past year.

There are 10 voting members of the Policy Committee, but all Trustees, A. A. World Services Directors, *Grapevine* Directors, and Staff Members are invited to attend and participate in Policy Committee meetings.

Other Board Committees make informal reports to the Policy Committee so that matters of public relations, finance, A. A. services and publishing can be discussed with respect to their effect on A. A. policy.

During the past year the Policy Committee considered 23 items, 10 of which had been referred by the Public Information Committee (a subcommittee of the Policy Committee), 3 by A. A. World Services, Inc. 3 by A. A. Area Trustees, 2 by the Conference Secretary, 2 by the 1960 Convention Committee, and 1 each by the Literature Committee, the *Grapevine*, and the Study Committee on A. A.'s Relations with Outside Agencies. Recommendations from the Policy Committee on these matters went to the General Service Board for its consideration and action.

GROUP RECORDS AND DIRECTORY

(Beth Kuhlman)

As A. A. grows, so does the G. S. O.'s responsibility to serve more and more Groups, Central Offices, Clubs, Lone Members and Internationalists.

This can only be done by constant efforts to improve communications between all A. A.s and your General Service Office.

The World Directory is the ultimate result of working together during the year so that members throughout the world may share experience, strength and hope with each other when the need arises.

As a result of Conference approval last year, the Directory and mailing information were sought separately. The G. S. O. Information Card was mailed in October, 1960, with the thought that, having correct mailing information beforehand, the Directory Card mailed in January, 1961, would have a better opportunity to reach all groups. Approximately 60% of the groups responded to the Directory mailing. About 50% returned the G. S. O. Information Card.

The Conference also approved a special Census mailing. Cards for obtaining census figures were mailed to all groups with the G. S. O. mailing in October. Data on "active members" was sought, as well as "total membership" to include members not usually counted because they might not participate regularly in

group activities. About 50% of the Groups returned special census figures.

The separate mailing of G. S. O. Information and Directory cards did have a disadvantage in that there was confusion as to the exact purpose of each card. In some cases, a Directory card was not returned because it was thought that the earlier G. S. O. Information card was for Directory Information.

In other cases, the G. S. O. mailing Information Card contained Directory information and this involved extra time in checking the office records. The same checking procedure was followed again in January. This actually involved extra working time on the records from October, 1960 through January, 1961. Last year the checking of information on the cards started in January, after the mailing of the G. S. O. card and Directory card together. Because of these disadvantages, it is recommended that the simplified procedure of one mailing be adopted in the future.

Cooperation from the groups has been excellent in obtaining up-to-date information, and it is gratifying to note the help and cooperation from Delegates and Committeemen in directing detailed information about the groups in their area toward G. S. O. so that better service may be rendered.

1960 CONVENTION

(Hazel Rice, Convention Secretary)

The largest assembly of sober alcoholics and their relatives and friends in the history of A. A. gathered at Long Beach, California July 1-3, 1960 to commemorate the 25th anniversary of the founding of Alcoholics Anonymous.

No completely accurate tabulation of total attendance was possible since many who attended several special presentations were not required to register for the Convention. It is estimated, however, that from 10,000 to 12,000 men, women and children joined in the three-day birthday tribute to A. A.

"Rededication to service" was the theme of the meeting, summarized eloquently by Bill W., surviving co-founder, in several major talks.

Despite the "promising beginnings" made by the movement during its first quarter of a century, "A. A. can scarcely congratulate itself for any wholesale successes," Bill told one gathering in Long Beach Memorial Stadium. "Instead," Bill said, "the movement must rededicate itself to the immense task of service which lies ahead."

He emphasized that A. A. had no desire to "dry up the world" but only wished to make its recovery program more widely available to problem drinkers who seek sobriety. The A. A. fellowship must continue to beware of the temptations to accumulate money, power or prestige, Bill pointed out.

A highlight of the Convention was the reading of a congratulatory message from President Dwight D. Eisenhower, one of many received from members, groups and friends of the Society throughout the world.

The weekend meeting opened Thursday night with a "get-acquainted" Kick-Off Dance that attracted several thousand members and friends. It closed with a special "Big Show" featuring Hollywood personalities (a number of them A. A.s themselves) that attracted nearly 8,000 to the Stadium Sunday night. These festive affairs were arranged by the Southern California Host Committee.

In between, scores of meetings, many of them held simultaneously, kept Conventioneers on the move. These included: (1) "Special Presentations" featuring guest speakers and A. A. members who discussed various phases of the recovery program; (2) "A. A. Workshops" in which members from many groups shared their experience in applying A. A. traditions to the structural problems of the movement; (3) Typical A. A. meetings, virtually "around the clock;" (4) Three general convention sessions at the Stadium.

Meetings of the Al-Anon Family Groups movement were also held in Long Beach during the A. A. Convention.

The A. A. meeting was only the third international conclave of the movement since its founding in 1935. The first was held at Cleveland in 1950 and the second at St. Louis in 1955. Although the Long Beach meeting, like its predecessors, was sponsored directly by the General Service Board, much of the credit for its success is due to the outstanding planning and support of the Southern California groups. The Convention did not produce a financial profit but was considered highly effective in bringing the A. A. recovery program to the attention of many alcoholics and interested non-alcoholics throughout the world.

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE OPERATIONS

(Herb Morse, Chairman)

Each year brings increased activity to G. S. O., and the year 1960 was no exception. Mail activity — counting incoming and out-going letters — reached a total of 258,000 compared to 215,800 in 1959. The Shipping Department wrapped and shipped more than 29,000 packages, 2,000 more than in 1959.

The number of orders for books, pamphlets, etc., processed by the Accounting Department dropped from 10,270 to 9,806 — but the average order was larger and pamphlet volume increased from 750,000 to 845,000. The Accounting Department also handled 8,428 contribution remittances.

Each registered group received, free of charge, a World Directory (printing and mailing cost \$1.75); monthly bulletins (annual printing and mailing cost \$2.00); and letters answering specific problems (each costing approximately \$2.50).

INCOMING MAIL ITEMS	54,819
(Inquiries, Group Communications, Contributions, Orders, etc.)	
OUTGOING MAIL ITEMS	203,184
(Including Monthly Bulletins — 12,000 per month)	
PACKAGES WRAPPED AND SHIPPED	29,039
(36,833 books, 845,055 pamphlets, 37 record sets, 197,804 wallet cards)	

The Accounting Department processed 9,806 orders for books, pamphlets, etc. and handled 8,428 contribution remittances.

Distribution of Books, Pamphlets and Miscellaneous Items in 1960

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (Old Edition).....	42
Alcoholics Anonymous (Revised Edition).....	24,533
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions.....	8,545
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age.....	3,713
Total Books Shipped	36,833

Pamphlets

This is A. A.	95,086
A. A. — 44 Questions & Answers	86,953
Is A. A. for You?	118,342

Pamphlets (Continued)

Partners in A. A.	25,559
Young People and A. A.	31,789
A. A. for the Woman	30,517
A. A. Tradition — How it Developed	19,185
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	25,992
Alcoholism the Illness	47,103
The Alcoholic Husband	56,724
The Alcoholic Wife	34,886
The Alcoholic Employee	21,001
A. A. & The Medical Profession	27,121
A. A. — Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism	62,567
Tranquilizers, Sedatives & the Alcoholic	42,157
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	34,699
Fortune Reprint	25,423
Good Housekeeping Reprint	29,446
Inside A. A.	18,256
Third Legacy Manual	5,062
Third Legacy Manual Excerpt	757
Foreign Translations	6,430
Total Pamphlets Shipped	845,055

Miscellaneous

Wallet Cards — Serenity Prayer	11,260
Wallet Cards — Two Fold	186,544
Parchment Scrolls	1,470
Lasker Award Replicas	57
How It Works (Excerpt from Big Book)	18,598

Records

Milestones Ahead	18
A. A.'s Three Legacies	19
Total Record Sets Shipped	37

Thirty full time and two part time persons are employed at G. S. O. in the following categories: A. A. Staff (7); Stenographic, filing, telephone and records (12); Accounting 4½; and Shipping (7½).

REPORT ON CLUBHOUSE SURVEY

For Study Committee on Clubhouses and A. A.

(Lyb Symington, Study Committee Secretary)

On the recommendation of the 1960 Conference that a basic study be made of the relationship of clubhouses to the A. A. movement, a club questionnaire was approved by the Study Committee on Clubhouses and A. A., and then mailed to 320 clubs on the G. S. O. mailing list. Conference Area Delegates and Committeemen also were sent copies of the questionnaire and were asked to cooperate in the survey.

The Club questionnaire was designed to obtain a movement-wide picture of clubhouse management, finances and activities in relation to A. A. in the community. Questionnaires from 219 clubhouses were returned to G. S. O., a very satisfactory number. Questions which were answered by "yes" or "no", have been recorded on a following page. The statistical comparison, however, is only a partial report. Many questionnaires were accompanied by letters explaining in detail some particular feature of the clubhouse, others enclosed by-laws, financial reports and leaflets outlining the purpose and use of the clubhouse by A. A. members.

From this wealth of new material, it now appears that the

general classification of "clubhouse" covers several types of operations, influenced to some degree by the size of the community and the age of A. A. in the area. However, it is clear that no matter whether a club is operating as a social club, a meeting place for an A. A. group, or a 12th Step house, it will be known in the community as an "A. A. Clubhouse". This is particularly true where there is only one group in a town and the members hire a room for meetings and list a telephone under "Alcoholics Anonymous." Therefore, it seems impossible to separate clubhouse activities from the community's picture of A. A. The majority of clubhouses reporting in this survey seem to be aware of this and their operations have been set up within A. A. Tradition.

SUMMARY: The survey points up the need for G. S. O. to have material (based on movement-wide experience) on several types of clubhouses and their relationship to A. A. in the community. It is recommended that this material on clubhouses and A. A. be prepared for distribution through G. S. O. and that its availability be announced in the A. A. Exchange Bulletin.

(See survey tabulation on following page)

SURVEY OF CLUBHOUSES

Questionnaires Mailed to 320 Clubhouses and to Area Delegates and Committeemen

Tabulation of Replies From 219 Clubhouses

FULL TIME CLUBS

(Open Every Day)

Based on 172 replies

	YES
1. Incorporated?	74%
2. Own clubhouse?	29.6%
3. Paid custodian?	67%
4. Accept outside money?	21.6%
5. Non-club members at A. A. meetings?	97%
6. Rent space to groups?	60.8%
7. Gambling permitted?	42.2%
8. a. Social club?	52.9%
b. A. A. center?	64.5%
c. "Rehab" house?	26.7%
9. Had newspaper, radio or TV publicity?	52.9%

PERMANENT MEETING PLACE

(Club open only for meetings and social events)

Based on 47 replies

	YES
1. Incorporated?	76.5%
2. Own clubhouse?	40.4%
3. Paid custodian?	38.2%
4. Accept outside money?	31.9%
5. Non-club members at A. A. meetings?	100%
6. Rent space to groups?	27.6%
7. Gambling permitted?	38.2%
8. a. Social club?	29.7%
b. A. A. center?	85.1%
c. "Rehab" house?	12.7%
9. Had newspaper, radio or TV publicity?	76.5%

10. If you own your club, how did you finance the purchase?

- a. We financed the purchase by contributions from members, dinners and long hard work.
- b. We financed the purchase of our club with certificates sold to the public, payable in ten years without interest.
- c. Members donated enough money to start building, most of the work was done by the members, then we borrowed enough to finish the building. Our loan has been repaid.
- d. We accepted a grant of \$2,000 from a Foundation to cover the down payment.

11. How do you raise operating funds?

- a. Only by collections from A. A. meetings.
- b. Pledges plus basket collections from meetings.
- c. Collections monthly from A. A. groups, weekly raffles of cake or candy and individual donations.
- d. By dues, card playing, collections from open A. A. meetings and rent from A. A. group, bingo and dances.

12. Is gambling permitted in your club?

- a. No gambling, but sheep'shead, cribbage and some poker is played. No stakes.
- b. Yes — for nominal stakes.
- c. We do not permit any form of gambling. Several clubs have closed because of gambling.
- d. Yes, but 2¢ limit on card games.
- e. No. We have found from experience that A. A. becomes secondary if gambling is prevalent.

13. What was the worst problems your club had?

- a. Getting A. A. members to join club. We have about 200 active members in the group, but only 83 members of the club.
- b. Purchasing our present building. 100 members left our group when we bought the club, but now we have 544 members, almost double since we moved in.
- c. Gambling and professional mooching. Simple process of elimination solved the problem.
- d. None of our problems are considered serious. But we have found that caution has to be exercised so that expenditures do not go beyond current income, with no long term commitments.
- e. Cards and finance. We stopped all high stake gambling. The financial problem adjusted itself.
- f. Maintaining payment of club dues.
- g. Raising the money to buy our building.
- h. Individuals come into the club in a drunken state and cause trouble. This is a hard matter to solve but we do the best we can.
- i. The usual growing pains in earlier days were solved by the clubs adhering to A. A. traditions. We keep the club separate from A. A. and cooperate with all groups in our area.
- j. Abuse of privileges by chronic slippers. We deny club privileges to offenders, but not attendance at meetings.

G. S. O. REPORTS

Approved Unanimously

LONERS AND LONER SPONSORSHIP

(Eve Marsh)

More than 500 lone members are registered at G. S. O., half of them outside the boundaries of the United States and Canada. To be geographically without A. A. contact is, in essence, the description of a "Loner". However, many Loners write to us saying that for the first time in their lives they feel they are not "alone"—through correspondence with G. S. O., with other A. A.s, through literature and awareness of the Higher Power.

Most Loners hope to find a way to attract another alcoholic, as a step toward forming a local group. Thus our Loners are beachheads for A. A.'s future.

Each Loner receives a special bulletin, "Loners Meeting," which is a sharing of our news and correspondence, as well as the regular A. A. Exchange Bulletin. In addition, our "Loner" group is able to share many ideas and receive much sponsorship by mail, through the dedication of many A. A.s, "Loner sponsors," with whom G. S. O. is in contact.

The need for Loner sponsors who can correspond in languages other than English is increasing. We continue to put "sponsoring" members and groups in touch with Lone members, and whenever possible provide a language contact. In addition, one G. S. O. staff member is assigned to correspond with Loners. The objective is to help answer many questions and afford the Loner an opportunity to build a solid base of sobriety. One member from South America, sober for some time, but not registered as a Loner, wrote recently: "It is too bad I did not know about registering as a Loner sooner, which would have made it possible for me to receive the material three months earlier. We had a couple here (man and wife) who were in pretty bad shape and I am sure I would have been able to pass along some of the literature to them, which would have enlightened them no end and served a useful purpose! As it was, he lost his job and they were sent back home."

G. S. B. NOMINATING COMMITTEE

(Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman)

The Nominating Committee recommends that, subject to the approval of the 1961 General Service Conference, Thomas A. Sharpe of Jacksonville, Florida be elected to fill the Class B Trustee vacancy to replace John Park Lee; David M. Bancroft be elected to fill the Class B Trustee vacancy to replace Charlie Brown; and Austin MacCormick be elected to fill the Class A Trustee vacancy, replacing Frank Gulden. The Committee further recommends that, subject to the approval of the 1961 General Service Conference, the following be nominated for election as Class A Trustees:

Leonard V. Harrison
Dr. John L. Norris
Austin MacCormick
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
Harrison M. Trice
L. Ivan Underwood

And the following be nominated for election as Class B Trustees:

Allan E. Bachman
David M. Bancroft
H. Sumner Campbell
Pat Cronin
Thomas A. Sharpe
Alfred Steckman

And further that, subject to the approval of the 1961 General Service Conference, the following officers of the General Service Board be elected:

Chairman Dr. John Norris
1st Vice-Chairman Bernard Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman Allan Bachman
Treasurer Archibald Roosevelt
Secretary H. Sumner Campbell
Asst. Secretary Mary Elizabeth Symington

1961 GENERAL SERVICE BUDGET

The budget for 1961 operations of the General Service Office, exclusive of the A. A. Grapevine, is as follows:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, GROSS PROFIT AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	<u>Income</u>	<u>Expenses</u>	<u>Net Income</u>	<u>Net (Deficit)</u>
General Service Office (Contributions)	\$230,000	\$237,800*	\$	\$ (7,800)
A. A. World Service (Gross Profit from Sales)	121,550**	83,500	38,050	
General Service Board		19,300		(19,300)
TOTALS	<u>\$351,550</u>	<u>\$340,600</u>	<u>\$38,050</u>	<u>\$ (27,100)</u>

ESTIMATED NET INCOME \$10,950***

* Including cost of General Service Conference.....\$28,500

** Based upon gross income from sales (totaling \$221,000) of
25,000 books "Alcoholics Anonymous"
8,700 books "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
3,500 books "A. A. Comes of Age"
Averaged — Pamphlets & Miscellaneous

*** Exclusive of Reserve Fund Appreciation of.....\$22,000

Expenses of G. S. O. for 1961 have been budgeted at \$5,550 under the 1960 expense. This was made possible because of the fact that 1960 figures included some non-recurring expenses. Actually the \$237,800 set up to meet the cost of general services recognizes that this must take care of (1) a substantial increase in new groups in 1961 and (2) increased services to all groups and (3) rising prices on printing, etc.

Contributions of \$230,000 are expected during 1961, \$12,420 in excess of the total received in 1961. This is regarded as a conservative estimate.

A budgeted deficit in the Group Fund/Office Expense account, amounting to approximately \$7,800, is expected unless contributions should exceed the Budget Committee's estimate for 1961.

1961 A. A. GRAPEVINE BUDGET

The budget for 1961 operations of The A. A. Grapevine, Inc. follows:

Estimated income from subscriptions and bulk sales.....	\$133,000
Total Expenses	\$132,430
Estimated Profit	\$ 570

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board:

Dear Archie:

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership.

Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audit. This practice will of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A. A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amounts I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A. A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A. A. member.

*Ever yours,
Bill
(Signed in full)*

WGW/nw

P. S. I hope that the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A. A. Grapevine, Inc.

DECEMBER 31, 1960

	December 31, 1960		December 31, 1959	
	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash (except Reserve Fund)	\$ 90,402	\$ 15,077	\$105,865	\$ 13,090
Accounts Receivable	5,370	2,690	4,057	1,964
Inventories	80,300	3,647	83,000	
Prepaid Expenses	7,891	6,880	21,282	6,844
Furniture and Equipment (net)	1	3,771	1	3,653
Investment in The Grapevine	1		1	
RESERVE FUND — Cash and Securities at cost (before provision in 1960 for \$25,000 transferred to Group Fund)	219,974		198,582	
Total Assets	<u>403,939</u>	<u>32,065</u>	<u>412,788</u>	<u>25,551</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	17,238	6,928	13,600	6,077
Unearned Income		47,442	14,075	48,620
Due General Service Board		11,570		11,570
Total Liabilities	<u>17,238</u>	<u>65,940</u>	<u>27,675</u>	<u>66,267</u>
NET WORTH				
Capital Stock		1		1
Accumulated Income (Deficit) (Exhibit B)	191,727	(33,876)	186,531	(40,717)
RESERVE FUND	194,974		198,582	
Total Net Worth	<u>386,701</u>	<u>(33,875)</u>	<u>385,113</u>	<u>(40,716)</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION				
World Service Office and Conference	\$ 11,513		\$ 12,285	
Publishing (Note A)	143,999		152,572	
General Fund (Note A)	36,215		21,674	
Reserve Fund	194,974		198,582	
Total — as above	<u>386,701</u>		<u>385,113</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1	\$198,582		\$172,260	
Book Discounts Donated	15,414		14,554	
Investment Income (net)	5,978		4,268	
Transfers from (to) Group Fund (Note)	(25,000)		7,500	
Balance December 31, as above	<u>194,974</u>		<u>198,582</u>	

NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS — In the attached statements the accounts of The A. A. Grapevine, Inc. are presented in one column, while the other column, under the heading of "Service Office", includes the accounts of The General Service Board of A. A., Inc. and A. A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of the General Service Board are further subdivided into three Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A. A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and subsequently, the costs of the General Service Conference.

COMBINED INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office and The A. A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1960

	<u>1960</u>		<u>1959</u>	
	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine
INCOME				
Sales and Subscriptions	\$214,166	\$151,026	\$198,708	\$138,472
Less: Cost of Products Sold	73,298	38,059	67,070	44,083
Royalties on Books	22,229		20,931	
Gross Profit from Sales	118,639	112,967	110,707	94,389
Contributions	217,580		210,163	
Total Income	<u>336,219</u>	<u>112,967</u>	<u>320,870</u>	<u>94,389</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	152,436	61,120	135,279	52,221
Rent	28,901	11,990	20,812	10,818
Service Office Printing	33,616		27,893	
Shipping and Mailing	20,389	11,327	16,287	11,409
Moving and New Equipment	20,911	2,045	972	762
Other Office Expenses	23,254	9,596	19,353	9,044
Insurance and Taxes	10,409	3,578	9,247	2,871
Professional Services, Honorarium	8,250	2,500	11,164	2,500
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	6,770	578	7,235	789
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	14,093		12,370	
P. I. C., Promotion, Travel	10,441	3,071	2,652	4,398
25th Anniversary Convention (net)	456			
General Service Conference	26,098	320	24,303	330
Total Expense	<u>356,024</u>	<u>106,125</u>	<u>287,567</u>	<u>95,142</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE)	(19,805)	6,842	33,303	(753)
ACCUMULATED INCOME (DEFICIT)				
Balance, January 1	186,532	(40,717)	160,729	(39,964)
Transfers from (to) Reserve Fund (Note B)	25,000		(7,500)	
Balance, December 31 (Exhibit A)	<u>191,727</u>	<u>(33,875)</u>	<u>186,532</u>	<u>(40,717)</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION				
World Service Office and Conference	(\$ 25,772)		\$ 7,880	
Publishing	31,427		41,583	
General Fund	(25,460)		(16,160)	
Total — as above	<u>(19,805)</u>		<u>33,303</u>	

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A. A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office and Conference, and of the Reserve Fund and General Fund by those names.

NOTE A — After dividend of \$40,000 in 1960 paid by Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B — In 1960 \$25,000 was advanced by the Reserve Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to help make up the deficit in Group contributions, while excess contributions in 1959 permitted a repayment of \$7,500 to the Reserve Fund on account of similar advances in prior years. There remain unpaid advances of \$25,000 made in 1960, \$6,347.42 in 1958, \$14,917.78 in 1957 and \$15,000 in prior years.

G. S. B. FINANCE & BUDGETARY COMMITTEE

(Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer, G. S. B.)

Operations of A. A.'s General Services resulted in a deficit of \$19,804 in 1960. Of this deficit, approximately \$18,000 was in non-recurring expenses. An \$8,000 bookkeeping machine was purchased; there was approximately \$6,000 in connection with moving the offices, and about \$4,000 was charged to Travel and P. I. C. Promotion for expenses in connection with the 25th Anniversary Year promotion.

The publishing activities of A. A. World Services, Inc. earned \$31,427.

Group contributions in 1960 were \$217,580. The 1960 contributions were \$25,771 below the cost of Office and Conference expenses, and the sum of \$25,000 was transferred from the Reserve Fund to the Group Fund to make up this deficit. This increased the accumulated advances from the Reserve Fund to \$53,765.

The Reserve Fund had added to it in 1960 \$21,392 in book discounts donated and in investment income.

SUGGESTED SHARE OF 1961 BUDGET

Based on an estimated budget of \$237,800 and on the 1960 membership, the share of each state and province for the year 1961 is apportioned in the following schedule. For budget purposes, only groups in the United States and Canada have been included in the estimate.

U. S. A.					
STATE	1960 Membership	State & Province Share	STATE	1960 Membership	State & Province Share
Alabama	881	\$ 1,755	New York	8,005	15,920
Alaska	179	355	North Carolina	2,117	4,210
Arizona	758	1,510	North Dakota	492	980
Arkansas	682	1,360	Ohio	8,193	16,295
California	17,250	34,310	Oklahoma	1,269	2,525
Colorado	1,233	2,450	Oregon	884	1,765
Connecticut	1,730	3,440	Pennsylvania	4,024	8,005
Delaware	252	500	Rhode Island	214	425
District of Columbia	1,211	2,410	South Carolina	1,127	2,240
Florida	4,032	8,010	South Dakota	729	1,455
Georgia	899	1,790	Tennessee	798	1,590
Hawaii	265	530	Texas	5,809	11,555
Idaho	323	645	Utah	848	1,690
Illinois	7,184	14,290	Vermont	308	615
Indiana	1,946	3,870	Virginia	1,899	3,780
Iowa	1,639	3,260	Washington	1,825	3,635
Kansas	1,363	2,710	West Virginia	496	990
Kentucky	785	1,565	Wisconsin	1,998	3,975
Louisiana	1,680	3,340	Wyoming	187	375
Maine	439	875	Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	270	540
Maryland	1,464	2,910			
Massachusetts	3,120	6,205	TOTAL FOR U. S. A.	108,004	\$214,870
Michigan	4,900	9,745			
Minnesota	4,158	8,270	CANADA		
Mississippi	602	1,200	Alberta	925	\$ 1,840
Missouri	2,430	4,835	British Columbia	1,825	3,630
Montana	431	860	Manitoba	826	1,650
Nebraska	612	1,220	New Brunswick	336	670
Nevada	560	1,115	Newfoundland	102	205
New Hampshire	322	640	Nova Scotia	508	1,010
New Jersey	2,680	5,330	Ontario	3,940	7,835
New Mexico	502	1,000	Prince Edward Island	144	290
			Quebec	2,203	4,385
			Saskatchewan	657	1,300
			Yukon Territory	37	75
			Northwest Territories	21	40
			TOTAL FOR CANADA	11,524	\$ 22,930
			TOTAL FOR U. S. A. & CANADA	119,528	\$237,800

1960 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS TO GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE FUND

(U. S. A.)—STATE	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita	(U. S. A.)—STATE	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	37	24	65%	\$ 1,862.00	881	\$2.11	South Dakota	39	22	57%	1,120.00	729	1.54
Alaska	15	10	67%	407.00	179	2.27	Tennessee	45	24	53%	1,338.00	798	1.68
Arizona	55	34	62%	1,689.88	758	2.23	Texas	272	143	53%	9,682.91	5,809	1.67
Arkansas	48	29	61%	1,078.50	682	1.58	Utah	45	25	56%	835.25	848	.99
California	801	495	62%	32,011.42	17,250	1.86	Vermont	23	18	78%	694.78	308	2.26
Colorado	59	43	73%	3,064.54	1,233	2.49	Virginia	97	69	71%	3,892.60	1,899	2.05
Connecticut	82	55	67%	4,140.50	1,730	2.39	Washington	124	88	71%	4,262.88	1,825	2.34
Delaware	14	9	64%	344.00	252	1.37	West Virginia	37	17	46%	764.22	496	1.54
District of Columbia	22	15	68%	2,095.50	1,211	1.73	Wisconsin	143	97	68%	4,405.50	1,998	2.20
Florida	195	105	54%	6,847.35	4,032	1.70	Wyoming	21	19	91%	837.00	187	4.48
Georgia	60	32	53%	1,810.50	899	2.01	Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	13	11	85%	620.50	270	2.30
Hawaii	20	9	45%	473.00	265	1.79	Total for U. S. A.	5,875	3,690	63%	\$191,592.89	108,004	\$1.77
Idaho	22	14	64%	775.00	323	2.40	(CANADA) — Province						
Illinois	434	388	89%	5,557.50	7,184	.77	Alberta	89	56	63%	2,252.05	925	2.43
Indiana	140	74	53%	3,376.15	1,946	1.73	Atlantic Provinces						
Iowa	74	49	66%	3,147.80	1,639	1.92	New Brunswick	23	12	52%	462.14	336	1.38
Kansas	79	60	76%	2,730.25	1,363	2.00	Newfoundland	7	4	57%	155.00	102	1.52
Kentucky	70	46	66%	2,723.35	785	3.47	Nova Scotia	41	30	73%	1,200.62	508	2.36
Louisiana	77	37	48%	2,843.46	1,680	1.69	Prince Edward Island	6	3	50%	232.57	144	1.62
Maine	42	28	67%	1,114.53	439	2.54	British Columbia	131	85	65%	4,702.25	1,825	2.58
Maryland	79	54	68%	2,723.00	1,464	1.86	Manitoba	38	26	69%	1,803.78	826	2.18
Massachusetts	172	85	49%	4,571.79	3,120	1.47	Northwest Territories	4	2	50%	83.33	21	3.96
Michigan	278	160	58%	9,233.18	4,900	1.88	Ontario	277	171	62%	7,722.36	3,940	1.96
Minnesota	204	164	80%	6,644.21	4,158	1.60	Quebec	152	54	36%	2,294.60	2,203	1.04
Mississippi	30	20	67%	996.00	602	1.65	Saskatchewan	63	42	67%	1,548.84	657	2.36
Missouri	132	83	63%	3,808.50	2,430	1.57	Yukon Territory	2	1	50%	81.20	37	2.20
Montana	41	23	56%	762.73	431	1.77	Total for Canada	833	486	58%	\$ 22,538.74	11,524	\$1.96
Nebraska	53	29	55%	1,208.00	612	1.97	Total for U. S. A. & Canada	6,708	4,176	62%	\$214,131.63	119,528	\$1.79
Nevada	29	18	62%	783.00	560	1.40	FOREIGN	1,112			2,556.63	17,737	
New Hampshire	23	11	48%	611.00	322	1.90	Lone Members				**	488	
New Jersey	184	105	57%	5,348.90	2,680	2.00	Internationalists				378.62	236	
New Mexico	36	29	81%	969.74	502	1.93	Hospital Groups	360			464.73	6,675	
New York	398	242	61%	17,264.97	4,005	2.16	Prison Groups	435			71.75	17,373	
North Carolina	117	66	56%	3,776.16	2,117	1.78	GRAND TOTAL	8,615			\$217,603.36	162,037	
North Dakota	34	21	62%	888.00	492	1.80							
Ohio	89	189	49%	9,664.55	8,193	1.18							
Oklahoma	59	56	49%	3,922.94	1,269	3.09							
Oregon	30	45	56%	1,602.71	884	1.81							
Pennsylvania	232	152	66%	8,021.34	4,024	1.99							
Rhode Island	20	9	45%	471.00	214	2.20							
South Carolina	70	40	57%	1,775.30	1,127	1.58							

** Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Delegates at each General Service Conference are encouraged to seek information about G.S.O. operations and to raise questions regarding problems of movement-wide concern. Problems and questions may be posed for general discussion and submitted anonymously in writing. Questions, including some duplicates, submitted by Delegates to the 1961 Conference may be summarized as follows:

1. Is it within the Tradition of Anonymity for Delegates' names to be submitted to non-A.A. organizations for use in a mailing seeking the 1965 Convention?

Answer: G.S.O. does not mail out such listings. This can be done only with the consent of the Area Delegate. Although the Directory is listed on the literature order blank, orders have to come through Group Secretaries. More education may be needed regarding these confidential lists.

2. Are donations to A.A. tax deductible?

Answer: Contributions to G.S.O. are deductible from Federal tax. The status of donations to individual groups varies from place to place. Each group must apply to the Commissioner of Internal Revenue for its own tax exemptions. If exemption has been allowed in a Regional Office, it applies to all groups in the area. Exemption from state taxes varies from state to state.

3. Has the pamphlet, "Young People And A.A." been rewritten to include new stories of younger people?

Answer: Revision of this pamphlet has been under discussion for more than a year. It has not been completed because there is not yet enough new material available to broaden its scope. Delegates are requested to submit new material in order to bring it up to date.

- 3A. Is the proposed pamphlet for the clergy near completion?

Answer: Yes. The manuscript has been sent to various members of the clergy for their comments.

4. Is the television show, "Days of Wine and Roses," being made into a movie?

Answer: Yes.

5. Is the mailing to G.S.R.s a help in furthering our Third Legacy of Service?

Answer: (By Jo W., British Columbia) Experience shows G.S.R.s in our Area stimulate more group interest when in direct communication with G.S.O. The mailing sent directly to the group may not be brought to the attention of group members.

6. How many of the Delegates at the 1961 Conference subscribe to the Grapevine?

Answer: Two-thirds of the Delegates subscribe. Many of the others purchase it through their groups.

7. The ten A.A. groups in Mexico do not seem to be enough for a country bordering on the United States. Is this lack of A.A. caused by the language difference?

Answer: No. The Spanish Group in Mexico City, although relatively new, is doing great work and more growth is expected. This group puts out a Spanish bulletin and G.S.O. has just inaugurated a bulletin in Spanish.

8. How many Areas allow proxy votes from prison groups in selecting Delegates?

Answer: One, Washington.

9. Would it be possible to issue a new pamphlet for the women alcoholic?

Answer: Referred to Conference Literature Committee.

10. Could we have the excerpt from the Big Book, on "How it Works," on a wallet-size card with the Twelve Steps?

Answer: Referred to the Conference Literature Committee.

11. When is the next meeting of the group known as "Doctors in A.A.?"

Answer: In August.

12. Are figures available on the number of Alateen groups and their membership?

Answer: Since Alateen groups are not affiliated with A.A., the questioner was referred to Al-Anon for specific information.

13. When will Bill's writing on "Twelve Concepts of Service" be available?

Answer: The Trustees are now considering this matter.

14. Would it be possible to have a new pamphlet printed to condense the Third Legacy into "Twelve Service Guides" or similar type of "twelve points?"

Answer: This is also being considered by the Trustees.

15. Iowa State Penal Institution at Fort Madison will expand its A.A. group to some 350 members, about 25% of the inmate body. They have only one meeting a week and only a very small percentage will have an opportunity to participate. Do other penal groups find it advisable to hold one large meeting?

Answer: This often depends upon the facilities available when there is one meeting night. It is not always ideal—but it is better than nothing. If it does work, officials may be willing to provide more room and allow more meetings.

16. Several people in their teens and early twenties have joined our local groups and are doing a fine job. We feel a "young people's" group might be helpful. Does A.A. experience indicate such a group would better serve all concerned?

Answer: (John K., Delegate from Conn.) Young people's groups are helpful as a supplement, but not as a substitute, to regular groups. It is helpful to pick someone of the same age level and background to work with the individual.

17. How can we explain A.A. to outside agencies particularly in regard to what A.A. cannot or will not do? Is G.S.O. preparing any material along these lines?

Answer: The report that came out of the Study Committee on Relations With Outside Agencies will be helpful in this area. It suggests that Area Delegates establish contact with Directors of the local agencies concerned with alcoholism. Only through learning their problems and objectives do we learn how we can cooperate with them.

18. What is the Birthday Plan?

Answer: A plan under which members donate \$1 to G.S.O. for each year of sobriety, with a maximum limit of \$10.

19. In our Area, Public Information was put in the wrong hands as far as most of us are concerned. Is this problem widespread?

Answer: This is an experience many have shared, according to G.S.O. correspondence. This is the main reason for having a Committee: to provide a "group conscience" in presenting the picture of A.A. to the outside public.

20. Are there any provisions in the constitution or by-laws of the Assembled Conference which enables the Chairman to refuse to seat or recognize a duly elected Delegate?

Answer: The Conference operates in accordance with the Charter approved by the movement at St. Louis in 1955; it does not have a constitution or by-laws. In the Third Legacy Manual, which is based on the Charter, the procedure outlined (section on Assembly Meetings: How Conducted) calls for the Area Committee to send the name and address of a new Delegate to the Conference secretary at G.S.O., thereby providing authorization for seating the Delegate. If any difficulty arises, the matter is brought to the Conference Committee on Admissions.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

21. Public meetings in my Area seem to have lost their attraction to the still suffering alcoholic. Have they lost their effectiveness for A. A.'s future growth?

Answer: Not at all. One Area invites civic groups to public meetings. There is response and growth from these meetings. In another Area they don't have open meetings—one Friday they have one monthly meeting which is dedicated to a particular segment of the community, such as doctors, lawyers or industry. The size of the crowd is not important, as friends are made one at a time.

22. The 1957 Conference recommended consideration of a pamphlet, including case histories of the Skid-Row alcoholics, that might be made available in jails. Has anything been developed?

Answer: "Memo to an Inmate" is now available for use in jails and prisons.

23. In 1954 the Conference approved the principle that any group with a regular secretary registered at G. S. O. should be entitled to one vote in an Area Assembly—should a Central Office or Central Committee have this privilege?

Answer: This depends on local feeling. The Assembly meeting in an area has the right to determine who shall vote and who shall be seated. This is covered in the Third Legacy Manual.

24. Is the G. S. O. Public Information Committee staying in accord with the policy of "attraction rather than promotion?" Could we be deceiving ourselves without realizing it?

Answer: The P. I. Committee adheres closely to Traditional A. A. public relations policy. A membership campaign would be promotion, for instance. We have not done anything like this, nor do we plan to. People do have to know about A. A., however. We believe we are following the policy of attraction in making the facts available to media.

25. Are both Intergroup and Area Committees essential to the service program? How should areas of responsibility and policy be defined to eliminate possible duplication?

Answer: In one area where A. A.s have both an Intergroup Office and a General Service Committee, they discuss the line of division at regular intervals. The metropolitan office works on local matters, while the Area Committee handles state and national matters. Both committees find it advantageous to work together on some activities.

26. The founder of a small-town group has been going on week-long binges at frequent intervals for the past year. It is undermining respect for A. A. in our community. What can we do?

Answer: There is nothing much anyone can do.

27. Should clubs and Twelfth Step Houses be included in Directory?

Answer: Clubs are listed in the Directory in order to help traveling members. Twelfth Step Houses are not listed. This listing depends on the information as we receive it.

28. Have we any right to make decisions regarding information on men wanted by the authorities? Are we justified in assuming that A. A. comes first and good citizenship second when it involves public policy toward law violators? (This question arose in discussion of the September, 1960 mailing by the Federal Bureau of Investigation, listing of groups.)

Answer: The sense of various comments on this question was that the G. S. O. was not making judgments on matters of public policy but had felt concerned to advise the F. B. I. of the A. A. Tradition of Anonymity following the Bureau's "unauthorized" use of the Directory.

29. There has been solicitation of Delegates on the part of officials in some cities wishing to have the 1965 Convention. The group Directory may not have been used for this purpose but the list of Delegates was. How did the promoters obtain the list of Delegates?

Answer: G. S. O. had nothing to do with releasing this list to outsiders.

30. Would like to have the mailing cover on the Grapevine discussed for a possible change. Present cover breaks our anonymity.

Answer: Paper is now thicker and wrapper wider, also title, *A. A. Grapevine*, is now regularly printed in middle of cover. The Grapevine can also be mailed first class upon request at an extra charge of \$1.50.

31. When does a group get to the size where members lose the sense of friendship and concern evident in small groups? Is it better for all concerned to have several small groups in the same town rather than one large group?

Answer: There is no fixed pattern. Some Areas report that too many very small groups can be as undesirable as one or two very large groups.

32. Should city and county jails where turnover is rapid have groups or just sponsored meetings?

Answer: Where there is rapid turnover there must be more cooperation from local A. A. groups. In institutions where terms are more than 90 days, it is possible to establish internal A. A. groups.

33. Has the pamphlet, "Memo to an Inmate" been approved by the Conference?

Answer: This pamphlet was recommended by the 1959 Conference. The final draft was reported to the General Service Board last year. Copies were sent to all members of the Conference Literature Committee for their comments and suggestions. Reviews were enthusiastic, so it was approved.

34. Does membership in A. A. incur any responsibility to a group or A. A. as a whole? Some groups are strongly divided on this question and it causes confusion in the minds of the newcomers.

Answer: The consensus of the Conference was that there is a moral responsibility on the part of the individual to the group and A. A.

35. Is "A. A. Today" still available?

Answer: Yes.

36. Can a complete set of the Grapevine be purchased? If so, what is the price?

Answer: Yes, at \$100 a set.

37. Can staff members visit Areas when transportation expense is shared so smaller cities have advantage of their visits?

Answer: Yes. This done quite often.

38. Is the World Directory copyrighted?

Answer: Yes.

39. Such booklets as "Twenty-Four Hours A Day" have been helpful to many A. A. members. That is not Conference-approved A. A. literature, but is it possible that A. A. World Services, Inc. may publish a booklet along these lines?

Answer: This book was originally offered to G. S. O. A previous Conference decided that G. S. O. should not publish this particular book. There are no present plans for a booklet of this type.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

40. Should N. C. A. be allowed to exhibit or have booths at A. A. Conventions?

Answer: This has been a matter of local decision by local Convention Committees.

41. Are there any truck drivers' groups at any terminals across the country?

Answer: None have been registered at G. S. O.

42. Does the General Service Office maintain a list of speakers available for Area Conferences and Conventions?

Answer: There is no "list", but the office is glad to help out, when possible and appropriate.

43. Does a person from an outside group acting as contact to an institutional group act as their G. S. R. and have voting privileges for the election of Delegates?

Answer: This is a local matter and depends on the wishes of other Assembly members.

44. Will a copy of the Conference Report be mailed to each G. S. R.?

Answer: Copies of the Final Conference Report go to Delegates and Committeemen. The Report is available to G. S. R.s at \$1 a copy.

45. Was it planned to forward to all groups, or to Committeemen, a copy of the report of the Study Committee on A. A.'s Relations With Outside Agencies?

Answer: This is service material and is available free of charge upon request.

46. What relationship exists between the A. A. Grapevine and the many local bulletins that are now in existence.

Answer: None.

47. We note that gambling provides income for some clubs. Is this governed by the club charter alone?

Answer: This will be answered in the forthcoming Fact File on Clubs.

48. How do you get secretaries to read announcements about clubs and other extra-curricular activities?

Answer: Opinion varies but one Delegate noted that Secretaries should read only A. A. announcements.

49. Is there an acceptable method whereby a club can make a contribution to the General Service Office?

Answer: Since some clubs are established as "outside A. A.," we credit such contributions to the group or groups meeting in the club, whenever possible.

50. Would it be possible to prepare a pamphlet based on the chapter, "How It Works," in The Big Book?

Answer: This was referred to the Literature Committees of the Conference and General Service Board.

51. How about more pamphlets for woman alcoholics?

Answer: This was referred to the Literature Committees of the General Service Board and Conference.

52. Would it be possible to have a brief discussion of Al-Anon at the 1962 Conference?

Answer: A vote of Delegates was taken. They were not in favor.

53. Has any effort been made to make the *Exchange Bulletin* available to individual A. A.s? If so, is the Office equipped to handle this business?

Answer: Yes. The *Exchange Bulletin* is still available at \$1 per year. Sales have dropped off because G. S. R.s are taking it to the groups.

54. Is there any way that the *Exchange Bulletin* could be printed in the Grapevine?

Answer: They serve totally different functions. The *Exchange Bulletin* is a newsletter and the Grapevine is an international magazine.

55. Could G. S. O. create a special fund to finance foreign publications?

Answer: A special fund within the Group Fund account has been earmarked to aid in the publication of foreign language pamphlets.

56. Is there any provision to show the Long Beach film to A. A.s visiting New York?

Answer: There are no definite plans, but the new film will be shown to succeeding Conferences.

57. For some time the A. A. Grapevine sent groups many flyers and "ads". Lately this seems to have been corrected. Has there been a change in policy?

Answer: The Grapevine had adopted a policy of attraction rather than hard sell. They will send flyers only when needed—this reduces the budget of promotion.

58. An outdoor advertising company has billboards idle between space contract periods. They offer A. A. use of some of these boards, provided that Intergroup Committee pays for the paper used. Is this an acceptable proposition? If so, how could space best be utilized?

Answer: The consensus was that such advertising would not be in line with Traditional A. A. public relations policy.

59. Has the possibility been discussed of making a film of G. S. O. the Grapevine Office, a segment of a yearly Conference and perhaps some committee meetings?

Answer: Many A. A.s are quite interested in capturing "the spirit of G. S. O." on film. There are a lot of complications and it is very expensive. These problems may be overcome in the future, subject to Conference approvals.

60. Have any methods been developed to gain the admission of alcoholics to hospitals?

Answer: It takes time. A number of Delegates noted the progress made in their Areas, but stressed that perseverance was necessary.

61. Could a plain cover copy of *A. A. Today* be made available for use in doctors' reception room where it might be seen by sick alcoholics who have not yet come in contact with A. A.?

Answer: We have 2,500 bound copies which could have the cover changed. There is no policy on this, and it has never come to the attention of the Grapevine that *A. A. Today* might have a wider use of this type.

62. How should we handle the racial question?

Answer: This is a matter for the individual and group conscience.

63. Why did the General Service Board have to pick up so much of the Convention expense?

Answer: This question was due to a misunderstanding of the role played by the General Service Board during the 25th Anniversary year. The Convention at Long Beach was basically self-liquidating. However, the Board did incur other Anniversary year expenses for such projects as the "Gratitude Luncheons" to media friends of A. A., the preparation of materials for A. A. Week (sponsored by the Advertising Council) and other special informational materials.

(All Conference Committee Reports Adopted Unanimously)

LITERATURE**REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON LITERATURE**

The Committee learned with pleasure of the offer made by Jerry M., the Delegate from Puerto Rico, to provide Spanish translators for A.A. material. The Committee urges the Board of Trustees to avail itself of this offer as the need arises and expressed its appreciation to the groups in Puerto Rico.

The Committee expressed its gratitude to the Board Literature Committee for the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate".

The Committee considered the recommendation transmitted by two Committeemen in South Florida to delete the words: "There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership" from the A.A. "preamble". After voicing its opinion that these words are of vital importance to the newcomer and in describing the Fellowship to the non-alcoholic, the Committee referred the recommendation to the Policy Committee.

The Committee received requests for copies of the last portion of Mr. Bernard Smith's talk. No action was taken since it will be included in the Final Conference Report.

The Committee noted with sympathy the recommendation that stories of a more personal nature be included when the pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman" is due for revision.

The Committee noted that progress has been made in the study of long range translation needs and recommends this study be continued, as authorized by the 1960 Conference.

The Committee noted with approval the recent availability of seven additional Spanish pamphlets.

The Committee urges Delegates to request young A.A.s to forward their case histories to G.S.O. before June 1, 1961, to assist in the revision of the pamphlet "Young People In A.A."

The Committee recommended that G.S.O. explore the possibility of preparing a more adequate description of Conference-approved literature.

AREA DELEGATES**REPORT OF THE "AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING**

The following members volunteered to serve on the Hospitality Committee of the 1962 Conference: Fred Visel, South-eastern New York; Louis Southworth, West Virginia; Ted Rothschild, Eastern Pennsylvania; John Keating, Connecticut; Ruth Mohler, Utah; and Jo Whitehouse, B.C., Canada.

It was suggested that the Southeastern New York Delegate be a member of the Hospitality Committee of future Conferences.

The selection of a Chairman for the "Area Delegates Only" meeting at the 1962 Conference was made by lot, in accordance with previous practice. The Delegate is Vince Strong, Southern Minnesota.

The Delegates request that G.S.O. protest to the management of the Hotel Roosevelt for the way certain Delegates have been treated in the matter of reservations and room charges.

After considerable discussion the Delegates approved continuation of the plan adopted in 1960 of placing qualified General Service Representatives on appropriate G.S.O. mailing lists. It was suggested that G.S.O. prepare a special form on which G.S.R.s would record data essential to maintaining up-to-date mailing lists.

The Delegates recorded their thanks to Mr. Leonard Harrison, to Herb Morse and to Anita Ryan for their work as officers of the 1961 Conference.

The Delegates approved the G.S.O. Reports as presented.

After the stenographer was asked to leave the meeting, a motion was made that the Board of Trustees be asked to make available as soon as possible to all Delegates a draft of Bill's current writing project on "The Twelve Concepts." The vote was 39 for and 20 against, with 25 Delegates abstaining. (It was announced later that drafts are available upon request.)

OUTSIDE AGENCIES**REPORT OF THE SPECIAL STUDY COMMITTEE ON RELATIONS WITH OUTSIDE AGENCIES**

The Committee recommends:

1. That Questions and Answers Number 19, 20 and 21 as submitted to the 1961 Conference, be added to the report, "A.A.'s Relations With Outside Agencies" approved by the 1960 Conference.
2. That, ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation: Yes—Affiliation: No," the Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism, for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.
3. That the Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with the Directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies within their respective Areas.
4. That the Study Committee be made a permanent Conference Committee.

GRAPEVINE**REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON THE GRAPEVINE**

The 1961 Grapevine Committee of the General Service Conference recommends the following:

1. The adoption of the Grapevine Group sponsorship program whereby groups are encouraged to send a new subscription, each month, to a local doctor, minister, psychiatrist, library, law-enforcement agency or member, prison or hospital, or any other person or agency selected by the group as a joint Twelfth Step venture.
2. Continue the action of the previous G.S.O. Conferences in establishing and encouraging Grapevine Representation at the State, Area and Group levels, depending on the problems and needs of each Delegate's area.
3. Where possible, appoint a knowledgeable A.A. member as a central Grapevine "editor" to search out A.A. writers and artists for Grapevine contributions.
4. Re-adopt the quota of 5,000 new subscriptions as a continuing goal for 1961.

AGENDA**REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE AGENDA**

The Agenda Committee reviewed the 1961 Agenda and recommended that its format generally be continued with the following suggestions:

1. That Area Highlights be reported *half* by first year and *half* by second year Delegates. This will give new Delegates the benefit of second year Delegates' experience.
2. That all Conference Participation be limited by clock to the following schedule -
 - 10 minutes Panel Chairman
 - 5 minutes Panel Speakers & Reports
 - 3 minutes Area Highlights
 - 2 minutes from the floor

This will allow more general discussion time and optimum participation by all.

During the coming year the Committee will review proposals and the Agenda for 1962 and advise G.S.O. accordingly.

The Committee expresses warmest thanks to Mr. Leonard Harrison, Herb Morse and Anita Ryan for their dedicated efforts in providing Delegates participation and making the '61 Conference an opportunity to better meet our responsibilities of Service.

ADMISSIONS

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS

The Committee reviewed the request of the Ontario General Service Conference Committee for a Third Delegate to serve the North and North-West section of the Province of Ontario, referred back from the Trustees of the General Service Board with the following memorandum from Bill.

MEMORANDUM ON NEW DELEGATES

"I've been asked to venture some opinions on the question of new Delegates to the General Service Conference.

"As we know, representation is now based on one Delegate from each State or Province, regardless of A.A. population. Then, in larger areas, we have extra Delegates, representing large populations. And in a few cases, where the areas are huge but sparsely populated, we have a few extra Delegates, these based on geographical considerations.

"For the operation of the Conference itself, this is a sufficiently representative cross-section of A.A. The actual Conference meetings would not be hurt if we had ten less Delegates, not appreciably helped if we had twenty more. For this particular purpose we have enough for the present. More Delegates would just mean more expense.

"But this isn't the whole story. On his return home it is not fair to burden a Delegate with too great a population of groups, even though he has plenty of committeemen. Nor is it fair to burden him with a huge and sparsely populated area, too big for him and his committee to manage. If we don't make adjustments of these conditions, then our local communications will suffer.

"Therefore the Conference Committee on Admissions should weigh each new application for a new Delegate on its own merit, taking into consideration the primary factors of population, geography—and also expense. But this process of adding Delegates ought to be gradual, aiming at the remedy of obvious and marked flaws in local communications. We should, our budget allowing, continue to remedy obvious flaws in local communications, and that is all.

"It should be re-emphasized that the Conference is not a political body demanding a completely rigid formula of representation. What we shall need will always be enough Delegates at New York to afford a reliable cross-section of A.A. plus enough more to make sure of good local communication.

"It is my understanding that Ontario has applied for an extra Delegate. Here I would prefer to express no specific opinion, this being the function of the Committee on Admissions and the General Service Board.

"I'm only suggesting that the frame of reference described above may be a suitable one within which to make each specific determination."

In view of the large geographical area and increasing A.A. population that can be covered only with difficulty by the present two Delegates from Eastern and Western Ontario areas, the Committee recommends:

1. That the request for a Third Delegate to serve the North and North-West section of the Province be approved.
2. That the additional Delegates be elected on Panel 11 to attend the 1962 General Service Conference.

TRUSTEES

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The Committee recommends unanimously the adoption of the Report of the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board.

The Committee confirmed the action of the Trustees of the General Service Board not to approve the request for permanent representation on the General Service Board of two Trustees from West of the Rocky Mountains. (A resolution presented to the 1960 Conference by the Delegate from the Southern California-Los Angeles Area). The matter has been referred to the Board's Policy Committee for further study.

FINANCE

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

The Finance Committee accepts the recommended budget as presented by the Finance and Budgetary Committee of the General Service Board and further recommends:

1. The adoption and continued use of the Birthday Plan to provide supplementary support of A.A. World Services.
2. That the present contributions yardstick of \$3.00 per member per year be affirmed and maintained.
3. That the Delegates consider various plans to increase their support of World Services that may prove most adaptable to their own areas (Information about these plans is available through G.S.O.)
4. That the adoption of any of these plans be reported to the Secretary of the Conference Finance Committee so that reports on them may be available for the 1962 Conference.
5. Approved the recommendation given in the International presentation that \$5,000 be taken from the General Fund and earmarked to assist overseas groups in the preparation and translation of Conference-approved literature for the period of one year only.

POLICY COMMITTEE

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The Policy Committee:

- A. Approved the recommendation that a form be filled in and signed by G.S.R.s who wish to receive duplicate mailings from G.S.O.
- B. Approved the Public Information Committee's procedure of considering financial obligations when G.S.O. is approached by film producers with a proposal for a motion picture on A.A. services.
- C. Approved the Public Information Committee's plan for an anonymity mailing to communications media in June, 1961.
- D. Approved the recommendation that a simplified procedure of mailing one card for Directory information be followed for next year's World Directory.
- E. Reaffirmed the 1959 Conference recommendation that in reference to the misuse of the Directory by A.A. members, their attention again be directed to its purpose as listed on the inside cover of the Directory: that it is not to be used as a mailing list for any form of solicitation or any commercial venture. That this be used as a guide and not a rule, as it is not intended to interfere with free communication among A.A.s in sharing experience and activities.
- F. Considered the recommendation that G.S.O. prepare a fact file (based on movement-wide experience) on several types of clubhouses and their relationship to A.A. in the community and that the availability of the fact file be announced in the A.A. Exchange Bulletin, and deferred decision. (Recommendation subsequently approved by the Conference.)
- G. Approved the Conference Literature Committee's recommendation that the sentence, "There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership" be retained in the description of A.A. in Conference-approved literature.

REPORT AND CHARTER

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON THE REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee on the Conference Report and Charter met and selected a Chairman from among members attending the Conference for the second year.

The first draft of the 1961 Conference Report will be referred to the members of the Committee for their consideration, suggestions, and corrections immediately after the Conference.

The draft will then be returned within ten days after thorough review by the Committee and the mailing of the Final Report will not be delayed.

1961 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

POLICY

Robert Koger, N. W. Texas
*Clarence Roberts, Georgia
Frank Gauthier, N. W. Ohio—S. E. Mich. Ohio
Watt Lindsay, Louisiana
Alvin Teshka, Central Michigan
Ruth Mohler, Utah
(Lyb Symington—Sec.)

TRUSTEES

Keith Christie, Manitoba, Canada
Mac MacQuivey, Idaho
*Robert Berschied, Kentucky
Dick Williams, Nevada
Ruth Betts, Southern Florida
Jo Whitehouse, B. C., Canada
(Anita Ryan—Sec.)

STUDY COMMITTEE

On Relations With Outside Agencies

Allan Bachman, Chairman
Dr. John L. Norris
Ralph Moxham, Nebraska
Al Ries, San Diego, California
Howard Pepper, Ontario, Canada
Tom Hampton, Maryland
Betty Traquair, So. & S. W. Ohio
Marie Shelton, Downstate Illinois
George Peters, Western Pennsylvania
Bob Hayes, Colorado
(Beth Kuhlmann—Sec.)

ADMISSIONS TO CONFERENCE

Dave Rosier, Tennessee
Jack Briscoe, Montana
*Fred Wallace, Kansas
Vince Strong, Southern Minnesota
Jules Pilcher, S. California - Los Angeles
(Anita Ryan—Sec.)

AGENDA

*Harry McGeorge, West New York
Jerry Maranville, Puerto Rico
Mauritz Kallerud, Wyoming
John Keating, Connecticut
Anne Craw, Northeast Ohio
Harry Tubbs, Hawaii
(Hazel Rice—Sec.)

CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

*Ruth Breen, Mississippi
Lee Hagemann, Downstate Illinois
Kate Reynolds, S. W. Texas
J. A. Newell, North Carolina
John Mooty, Southern Wisconsin
Lloyd Stetson, Northern Coastal Calif.
(Anita Ryan—Sec.)

FINANCE

Bertha Williams, No. Interior Calif.
*Jim Lewis, South Carolina
Phil Carter, Hud.-Mohawk-Berk., N. Y.
Bob Reid, Oklahoma
Ruth Dickens, Virginia
Hugh Chambers, District of Columbia
(Ann Macfarlane—Sec.)

GRAPEVINE

John Rae, Alberta, Canada
Hank Schlink, Oregon
Tom Hagenow, Vermont
*Fred Visel, Southeastern New York
Reece Hagerty, Northeast Texas
Norman Stone, North Florida
(Lee Beckwith—Sec.)

LITERATURE

*Jack White, So. Coastal California
Don McMullin, Atlantic Prov., Canada
John McIntyre, New Hampshire
Weldon Landers, Southeast Texas
Bourke O'Brien, Northern New Jersey
J. C. McLendon, Alabama
(Eve Marsh—Sec.)

STUDY COMMITTEE

On A. A.'s Relations To Clubs

Allan Bachman, Chairman
Mike Lastichen, South New Jersey
Louis Southworth, West Virginia
Ruth Breen, Mississippi
Jack White, So. Coastal California
Bill Connell, New Mexico
Mac MacQuivey, Idaho
Jerry Murphy, Washington
Omer Bernier, Quebec, Canada
(Lyb Symington—Sec.)

*Chairman

1961 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA	(11) <i>McLendon, J. C.</i> , Box 1481, Pensacola, Florida	MASSACHUSETTS	(11) <i>Eastern—Russell, Frank</i> , 159 Wentworth Ave., Lowell
ALASKA	(10) <i>Avre, Red</i> , Box 4-248, Spenard		(10) <i>Western—Smith, Mrs. Helena</i> , 17 Manitoba St., Springfield 8
ARIZONA	*(10) <i>Jackson, L. D.</i> , "Jack", 3115 North 41st St., Phoenix	MICHIGAN	(11) <i>Central—Teshka, Alvin</i> , R. R. 1, Hillsdale
ARKANSAS	(11) <i>Smith, G. D.</i> , Star City		(11) <i>Southeastern—Anderson, Arthur "Andy"</i> , 5191 Bowman Rd., St. Clair
CALIFORNIA	(11) <i>So. Calif.—L. A.—Pilcher, Jules</i> , 4758 Frieda Dr., L. A. 65		(10) <i>Western—Weaver, Robert</i> , 2327 Munson Ave., Traverse City
	(11) <i>No. Coastal—Stetson, Lloyd W.</i> , 340 Crestview Dr., Santa Clara	MINNESOTA	(10) <i>Northern—Bergum, Bob</i> , Route 2, Brainerd
	(10) <i>No. Interior—Williams, Mrs. Bertha</i> , 509 Orange Ave., Avenal		*(11) <i>Southern—Strong, Vince</i> , Box 266, Ortonville
	(10) <i>San Diego—Ries, Al</i> , 3216 3rd Ave, San Diego 3	MISSISSIPPI	(10) <i>Breen, Mrs. Ruth T.</i> , 4244 El Paso, Jackson
	(10) <i>So. Coastal—White, Jack</i> , 3055 McNab Ave., Long Beach 8	MISSOURI	(11) <i>Eastern—Paulette, Herman</i> , Box 437, Waynesville
COLORADO	(11) <i>Hayes, Robert G.</i> , 1376 Columbine, Denver 6		(11) <i>Western—Parsons, Leon</i> , Route 1a, Warrensburg
CONNECTICUT	(11) <i>Keating, John</i> , 41 Talcott Ave., Rockville	MONTANA	(10) <i>Briscoe, Jack</i> , 335 North Rodney St., Apt. 5, Helena
DELAWARE	(10) <i>Lockwood, Herman C.</i> , 223 East Market St., Georgetown	NEBRASKA	(10) <i>Moxham, Ralph</i> , 1729 So. 28th St., Omaha 5
DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA	(11) <i>Chambers, Hugh</i> , 2500 Wisconsin Ave., N. W., Washington D. C.	NEVADA	(11) <i>Williams, Dick</i> , 3329 North Rio Grande, North Las Vegas
FLORIDA	(11) <i>Northern—Stone, Norman</i> , Box 466, Tallahassee	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(10) <i>McIntyre, John</i> , 344 Belmont St., Manchester
	(11) <i>Southern—Betts, Mrs. Ruth</i> , Route 1, Box 348, Ft. Myers	NEW JERSEY	(11) <i>Northern—O'Brien, W. Bourke</i> , 36 South Walnut St., East Orange
GEORGIA	(10) <i>Roberts, Clarence</i> , 1803 8th St., Chamblee		(10) <i>Southern—Lastichen, Mike</i> , 213 4th Ave., Roebling
HAWAII	(11) <i>Tubbs, Harry T. "Hap T"</i> , 382 North Vineyard Blvd., Honolulu 17	NEW MEXICO	(10) <i>Connell, William C.</i> , 10020 Inca Ct N. E., Albuquerque
IDAHO	(10) <i>MacQuivey, Mac</i> , 1702 North 15th St., Boise	NEW YORK	(11) <i>Central—Gooley, William</i> , 418 Schuyler St., Syracuse 4
ILLINOIS	(11) <i>Chicago—Grimstad, George</i> , 11140 Windsor Dr., Westchester		(10) <i>Mohawk-Hudson-Berkshire—Carter, Phil</i> , 35 Park St., Williamstown, Mass.
	(11) <i>Downstate—Shelton, Mrs. Marie</i> , Box 398, Oblong		(11) <i>Southeastern—Visel, Fred</i> , 214 West Side Ave., Freeport, L. I.
	(10) <i>Downstate—Hagemann, Lee</i> , 209 East Lincoln St., Mt. Morris		(10) <i>Western—McGeorge, Harry</i> , 13 Napier St., St. Catharines, Ont., Canada
INDIANA	(11) <i>Gillette, Wayne</i> , Box 20123, Indianapolis 20	NORTH CAROLINA	(11) <i>Newell, J. A.</i> , RFD 1, Box 13-AA, Durham
IOWA	(11) <i>Emerson, Ed</i> , 2633 East Walnut, Des Moines 17	NORTH DAKOTA	(10) <i>Christianson, Ralph</i> , Watford City
KANSAS	(10) <i>Wallace, Fred</i> , Box 63, Emporia	OHIO	(11) <i>Central & S. E.—Huff, Warren</i> , 248 Columbian Ave., Columbus
KENTUCKY	(10) <i>Berschied, Robert</i> , 1410 North 11th St., Paducah		(11) <i>Northeastern—Craw, Mrs. Anne</i> , 122 South Chestnut St., Niles
LOUISIANA	(11) <i>Lindsay, Watt</i> , 2102 Creswell, Shreveport		(10) <i>N. W. Ohio & S. E. Mich.—Gauthier, Frank</i> , 1550 Avondale Ave., Toledo
MAINE	*(10) <i>Scotten, L. R. "Dick"</i> , 17 Ocean House Road, Cape Elizabeth		(10) <i>South & Southwestern—Traquair, Mrs. Betty</i> , 4150 Mt. Carmel Rd., Cincinnati 44
MARYLAND	(10) <i>Hampton, Thomas D.</i> , 437 Ilchester Ave., Baltimore 18		

1961 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
OKLAHOMA	(11) <i>Reid, Bob</i> , 803 North Hudson, Altus	WEST VIRGINIA	(11) <i>Southworth, Louis</i> , 1116½ Kanawha Blvd. East, Charleston 1
OREGON	(10) <i>Schlink, Henry</i> , 2335 S.W. 83rd Ave., Portland 25	WISCONSIN	(10) <i>N. Wisconsin & Upper Mich. — Borum, Homer</i> , 521 Niagara St., Eau Claire
PENNSYLVANIA	(11) <i>Eastern — Rothschild, Ted</i> , 28 So. Bank St., Philadelphia 6		(11) <i>Southern — Mooty, John</i> , Box 30, Beaver Dam
	(11) <i>Western — Peters, George</i> , 217 Puritan Rd., Rosslyn Farms, Carnegie	WYOMING	(10) <i>Kallerud, Mauritz E.</i> , 1516 W. 12th, Casper
RHODE ISLAND	(10) <i>Moore, Norman</i> , 130 Newton St., Weston 93, Mass.	PUERTO RICO	(10) <i>Maranville, Jerry</i> , Box 762, Bayamon
SOUTH CAROLINA	(10) <i>Lewis, Jim</i> , Box 36, Spartanburg	CANADA	(10) <i>Alberta — Rae, John</i> , Box 261, Taber
SOUTH DAKOTA	(10) <i>McGuire, Mrs. Helen L.</i> , St. Lawrence		(10) <i>Atlantic Provinces — McMullin, Don</i> , 210 Charlotte St., Sydney, N. S.
TENNESSEE	(10) <i>Rosier, Dave</i> , 301 Dogwood Dr., Maryville		(11) <i>B. C. - Yukon — Whitehouse, Miss Jo</i> , 2440 Bellevue, West Vancouver, B.C.
TEXAS	(11) <i>Northeastern — Haggerty, Reece</i> , 901 So. Dixon St., Gainesville		(10) <i>Manitoba — Christie, Keith</i> , 95 Kingston Row, St. Vital, Winnipeg
	* (10) <i>Northwestern — Koger, Robert</i> , Box 532, Lamesa		(11) <i>Ontario - Eastern — Boyle, Allen</i> , Apt. 6, 5775 Yonge St., Willowdale
	(11) <i>Southeastern — Launder, Weldon</i> , 1401 Conti St., Houston 2		(10) <i>Ontario - Western — Pepper, Howard</i> , 709 Devonshire Rd., Windsor
	(10) <i>Southwestern — Reynolds, Miss Kate</i> , 106 Rosemary Ave., San Antonio 9		* (10) <i>Quebec — Bernier, Omer</i> , 146 St. Antoine St., Chicoutimi
UTAH	(11) <i>Mohler, Mrs. Ruth</i> , Uranium Building, Moab		(10) <i>Saskatchewan — Barker, Ross A.</i> , Box 3028, Weyburn
VERMONT	(10) <i>Hagenow, Thomas</i> , 32 Hartness Ave., Springfield	CORRESPONDING MEMBERS	Norway — <i>Sonju, Hart</i> , 1117 East Earl St., Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
VIRGINIA	(11) <i>Dickens, Mrs. Ruth</i> , 2507 Rivermont Ave., Lynchburg		Holland — <i>Frylink, Adrian</i> , Box 339, Babylon, L. I., New York
WASHINGTON	(11) <i>Murphy, Jerry</i> , 727 So. Adams, Spokane 4		

* Alternates

1961 CONFERENCE MEMBERS

(Trustees - Office - Grapevine)

G. S. B. TRUSTEES

NON-ALCOHOLIC

Mr. Leonard V. Harrison,
(Chairman)
P. O. Box 223
Old Lyme, Connecticut

Dr. John L. Norris,
(Vice-Chairman)
Medical Department
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York

Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt,
(Treasurer)
200 East 66th Street
New York, N. Y.

Mr. Bernard B. Smith
460 Park Avenue
New York, N. Y.

Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
30 Milbank Avenue
Greenwich, Connecticut

Harrison M. Trice,
Professor
School of Industrial &
Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, New York

Mr. L. Ivan Underwood
Purchase Lane
Rye, New York
(One Vacancy)

ALCOHOLIC

Allan E. Bachman
37 Ocean Drive
Stamford, Connecticut

H. Sumner Campbell
390 First Avenue
New York, N. Y.

Pat Cronin
5257 Washburn Avenue So.
Minneapolis, Minnesota

John Park Lee
16 Forest Drive
North Haledon
Paterson 2, New Jersey

Alfred Steckman
40-01 Little Neck Parkway
Little Neck, L. I., N. Y.

Richard A. Stevens
2010 Oakmere Drive
Baldwin, L. I., N. Y.
(One Vacancy)

EMERITUS (Non-Alcoholic)

Mr. Frank Amos
136 23rd Avenue, S. W.
St. Petersburg, Florida

Mr. A. LeRoy Chipman
Midston House
22 E. 38th Street
New York, N. Y.

Dr. Leonard V. Strong, Jr.
133 East 58th Street
New York, N. Y.

A. A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Robert MacDevitt, Treasurer
Helen Wynn
Alfred Steckman
Richard A. Stevens, Chairman
Gurney Williams, Editor
Max Wylie
Mary Bernson

STAFF (Editorial)

Lee Beckwith
Helen Wynn

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Herb Morse
Beth Kuhlman
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Hazel Rice
Anita Ryan
Lyb Symington

A. A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Herb Morse, Chairman
Allan Bachman, Treasurer
Sumner Campbell, 1st Vice-Chairman
George O'Hara, 2nd Vice-Chairman
Lyb Symington, 3rd Vice-Chairman
Adrian Frylink
Eugene Kelley

OTHERS ATTENDING CONFERENCE

OFFICE STAFF

Gladys Huff
Dennis Manders
Camille Mele
Nell Wing

CONSULTANTS

Ralph W. Bugli (Literature)
Wilbur A. Smith (Ind. C. P. A.)

A. A. GRAPEVINE

Doris Holmes (Circulation)

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

April, 1961

NON-ALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

MR. LEONARD V. HARRISON - (Chairman of the General Service Board and Chairman of the General Service Conference) First came on the Board in 1941 and, with the exception of his resignation from October 1950 to January 1953, has been continuously active in A. A. affairs. For many years he served as director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

DR. JOHN L. NORRIS - (Next Chairman of the General Service Board, Chairman of Committee on Structure and Procedures and Chairman of the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board) Elected to the General Service Board in January 1951. He is Medical Director of Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, New York and has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics by both industry and community agencies.

MR. ARCHIBALD B. ROOSEVELT - (Treasurer of the General Service Board and Chairman of the Board's Finance and Budgetary Committee) Elected to the General Service Board in January 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc. and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs.

MR. BERNARD B. SMITH Elected to the General Service Board in June 1944, and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January 1951 to April 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth, during her visit to the United States.

DR. HARRY M. TIEBOUT Elected to the Board in April 1957. He was the first psychiatrist to recognize the work of Alcoholics Anonymous and to use A. A. principles in his own practice. In the early days when A. A. was little known, he was instrumental in having Bill W. speak before the Neurology and Psychiatry section of the Medical Society of the State of New York and before the American Psychiatric Association. He has written many notable articles, among them, "The Ego Factors in the Surrender of Alcoholism".

PROFESSOR HARRISON M. TRICE. Elected to the General Service Board in April 1957, serving on the Board and Literature Committee with great enthusiasm. He is a Professor in the School of Industrial and Labor Relations at Cornell University.

MR. L. IVAN UNDERWOOD. Elected to the Board in January 1955. He is a vice president in charge of the export activities of Republic Steel Corporation, traveling a great deal and visiting A. A. overseas. Through his efforts, A. A. Publishing, Inc. obtained translations of "A. A. and the Medical Profession" in French and in German.

A. A. TRUSTEES

ALLAN BACHMAN - (Director of A. A. World Services, Inc. and Chairman of General Service Board's Public Information Committee) He is Executive Vice-President of the National Better Business Bureau and the author of several books and a number of articles on business subjects for business and trade magazines. He joined A. A. in 1947 and is still an active member of the Stamford, Connecticut, group. He served as President of the New York Intergroup Steering Committee from June, 1956 to July, 1957. Elected to the Board in April, 1960.

PAT CRONIN. Elected to the Board in April 1959, following nomination by the A. A. groups in Minnesota. He was the first

A. A. in Minnesota, in 1940, and started the first group in the Twin Cities in 1941. He is Director of Pioneer House, a rehabilitation center in Minneapolis, and is presently serving on from Southern Minnesota to the General Service Conference the Mayor's Committee on Alcoholism. He served as Delegate in 1951 and 1952.

SUMNER CAMPBELL - (Secretary of the General Service Board, Vice Chairman of A. A. World Services, Inc. and Chairman of the General Service Board's Literature Committee) Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1959. He is also a Director of A. A. World Services, Inc., having served since May, 1957. He is Sales Manager for a manufacturer's representative, selling toys and housewares. He took his last drink on December 7, 1945, has been very active in A. A. in the New York Area and has served as Treasurer of the A. A. Intergroup Association in New York City.

JOHN P. LEE (Chairman of General Service Board's Policy Committee). Elected to the Board in April, 1957, following nomination by the A. A. groups in Pennsylvania. He has had 20 years of continuous sobriety. He has served as Chairman of the Steering Committee of the A. A. Central Office in Philadelphia. He is Public Relations Director of the Board of National Missions of the United Presbyterian Church in the U. S. A. (Term expires April, 1961.)

ALFRED STECKMAN - (Director of The A. A. Grapevine) Elected to the General Service Board in April 1958. He is Vice President in charge of the International Division, Fletcher Richards, Calkins & Holden, Inc., advertising agency, in New York City. He has been in A. A. for sixteen years and served as Secretary and Director of the New York Intergroup Association from 1945 to 1946. He served as Editor of The A. A. Grapevine from 1948 to 1952 and a Director of A. A. Publishing, Inc., from 1949 to 1951.

RICHARD A. STEVENS - (Director of The A. A. Grapevine) Elected to the Board in April 1957. He is currently an Account Executive and Media Supervisor for Fletcher Richards, Calkins & Holden, Inc., an advertising firm. He served as a Director of A. A. Publishing, Inc., from November 1955 to May 1957, and Business Manager of the A. A. Grapevine from 1941 to 1946. He also served as Treasurer of the New York Intergroup Association. (Term expires April, 1961.)

TRUSTEE NOMINEES

AUSTIN MACCORMICK (Non-A. A.) Trustee Nominee to replace Frank Gulden. He served on the Board previously from October 1949 to April 1951. He returned to New York and full time duty as Executive Director of Osborne Association, Inc., 114 East 30 Street, New York 16, N. Y., after retirement on June 30, 1960 from the faculty of the University of California at Berkeley.

DAVID M. BANCROFT (A. A.) Trustee Nominee from Montreal, Quebec, Canada. Nominated by A. A. groups in Quebec. Dave has had seventeen years of continuous sobriety in A. A. and was the first Delegate to the General Service Conference from the Province of Quebec. He introduced A. A. to Montreal and subsequently to all of the Province of Quebec. He has his own business, a general accounting service.

THOMAS A. SHARPE (A. A.) Trustee Nominee from Jacksonville, Florida. Nominated by A. A. groups in Florida. Tom has had eighteen years of continuous sobriety in A. A., and was the first Florida member. He was also the first North Florida Delegate to the General Service Conference, 1951 - 1952. He operates his own business, that of a manufacturer's agent.

PUBLIC INFORMATION ACTIVITIES

This material supplements G. S. B. Public Information Committee Report on Page 19

(Hazel Rice)

A summary of G. S. O. activities follows:

1. *Approximately 5,000 Inquiries:* Inquiries have been received from students, teachers, doctors, clergy, libraries, researchers and writers. These letters are answered and a minimum of two pamphlets, "44 Questions and Answers" and "Helpful Ally" are enclosed.
2. *Professional Exhibits:* Alcoholics Anonymous' exhibit, used solely at annual professional meetings, has been seen by an estimated 40,000 persons during the past year. From April 17th to the 20th, it is being shown at Miami Beach, Florida, at the American Academy of General Practices Annual Meeting.
3. *Outside Agencies:* G. S. O. has been in touch with the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs, National Council on Alcoholism, The National Association of Municipal Judges, The United States Federal Health Department, The American Medical Association, The American Bar Association, National Boards of the Episcopal, Methodist, Presbyterian and Baptist Churches. Pamphlets were sent to the annual meeting of the National Council of Catholic Clergy. For the first time, the combined American and United Kingdom Bar Associations scheduled an alcoholism panel at their annual meeting, referring to A. A. as one means of recovery.
4. *Magazines:* Articles have appeared in: Reader's Digest, Changing Times, MacLean's of Canada, Ladies Home Journal, IBM's "Think", Social Work, Christian Herald. Currently there is a possibility of articles in Look and Esquire.
5. *Advertising Council:* Through the cooperation of the Council, a non-profit public service organization, there were Twenty-fifth Anniversary mailings to some 3,065 radio stations and over 500 television stations. The group follow-through brought approximately \$1,000,000 radio and television air time to the carrying of A. A.'s message.
6. *Special Twenty-fifth Anniversary Public Meetings:* Special material for such meetings was made available to some 5,000 A. A.'s. It is estimated that approximately 50% of the A. A. groups around the world held such meetings.
7. *Anniversary Background Pamphlets:* 50,000 of these were distributed gratis during the past year.
8. *General Service Board Gratitude Luncheon:* The second annual Gratitude Luncheon to which G. S. O. invited a number of friends in the publishing and broadcasting fields, enabled the society to express formal appreciation to many who have been helpful in recent years.

Public information material prepared or up-dated by G. S. O. during the past year includes:

1. Radio and Television material. (Pattern interview scripts, announcements of the formation of new groups, special meetings, and spot announcements.)
2. Newspaper and General Press material. (Feature articles, sample announcements for new groups and special meetings.)
3. Background Information Pamphlet. (Answers questions frequently asked by non-A. A.s concerning A. A.)
4. Suggestions for A. A.s speaking to non-A. A. groups. (Compiled at the suggestion of A. A.s who speak to non-A. A. groups who are interested in learning more about A. A.)
5. Basic fact file. (Basic data on the movement, designed primarily for writers and editors.)

ADDENDUM

The 1961 Conference, through a resolution offered by A. A. Trustee John Park Lee, expressed unanimous appreciation to the Advertising Council, Inc. for the latter's sponsorship of A. A. Week (June 26 - July 3, 1960) in connection with the Society's 25th Anniversary Convention.